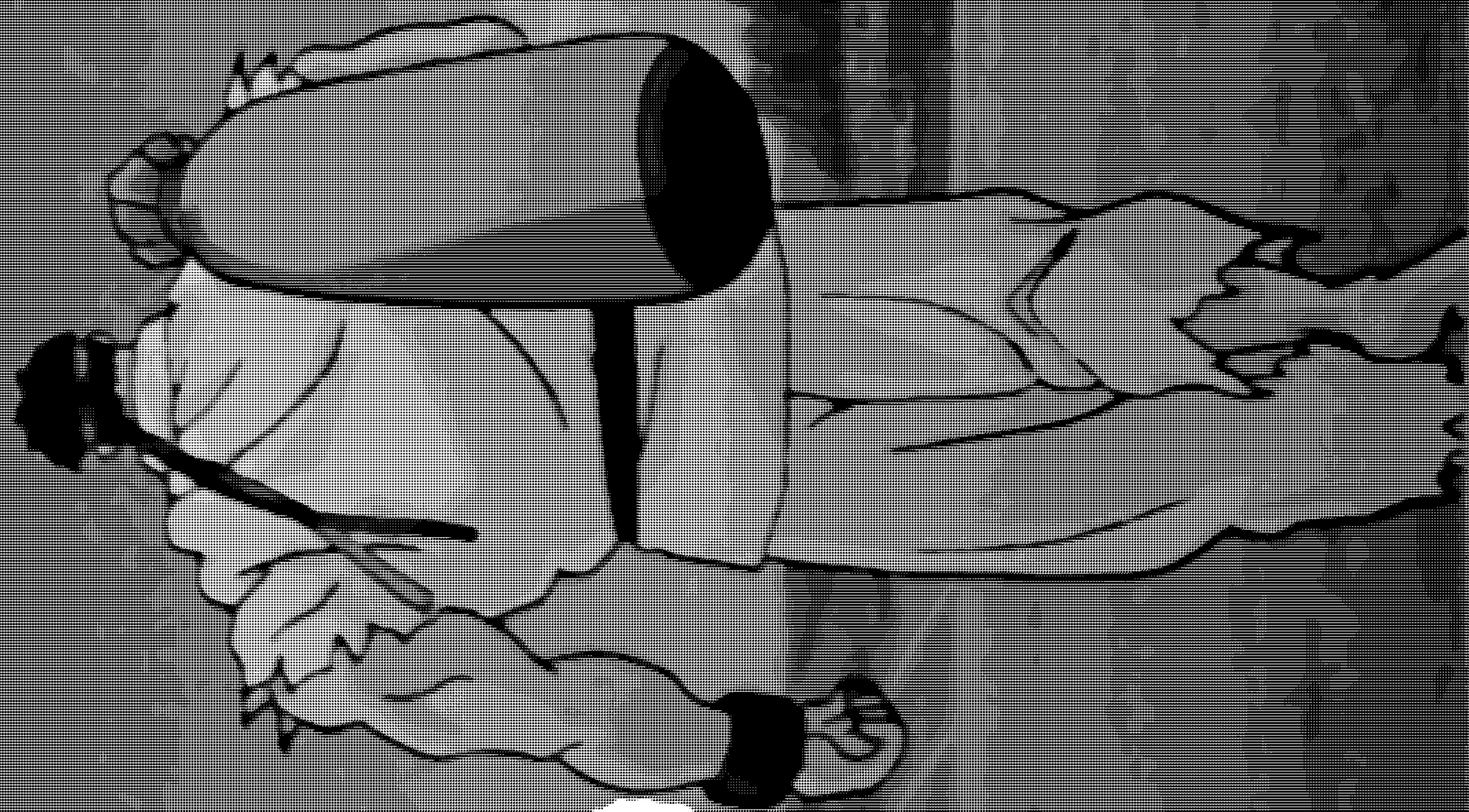




忍

無
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THE

格斗家们 背后的故事

《街头霸王》制作组长期着迷于本系列的格斗机制和人物刻画、剧情与背景?并不多。

《街头霸王II》结局中包含的故事片段是后来加的。超任游戏手册里塞的人物简介则更糟:例如隆的简介发生了翻译错误,宣称隆是“圣龙大师的徒弟”(原文指龙拳的研习者)。有些时候,游戏中的故事情节甚至还会相互矛盾。例如查理·纳什,在 α 中死在M.拜森手上,在 α 2中死于直升机扫射,在 α 3中前个版本幸存下个版本又死了。

“Official canon is a moving target,” says Neidel Crisan, Capcom's director of e-sports. “Most fans just appreciate some effort, and they'll suspend disbelief as long as there's some context provided for why that character is there.”

Yet Street Fighter's universe has also proven to be fertile ground for long-form storytelling. The series has inspired comics and manga, animated movies and cartoons, and even live-action films. Some of those have been so spot-on that Capcom has woven their narrative elements into the Street Fighter games; others have missed the mark so badly as to be erased from official Street Fighter history. For the most successful storytellers, the flexibility and undefined character of the official Street Fighter universe is an opportunity for unfettered narrative exploration.

“Because the official history is a little messy, we have had more leeway to join the dots together,” says Erik Ko, editor-in-chief of Udon Entertainment, a collective of artists based in Toronto that has produced many of Street Fighter's most popular comics. “It's given us quite a bit of creative freedom.”

In the following pages, we'll explore the most prominent Street Fighter storytelling: the tales that have brought the series' game world to life, as well as those that have gone sideways.

豪鬼夺取隆之灵魂的战斗是《街头霸王》中一条值得挖掘的故事线,隆对自我进步的无尽追求也是。(插画由阿尔文·李绘制)





大制作并不总是正解

1994年的《街头霸王》真人电影是一场做作的翻车

上图:《街头霸王》演员们展示了人物的胜利姿势;下页图:拜森将军(劳尔·朱力亚饰,译注:患癌病逝前的绝唱)在古烈上校(尚格云顿饰)的大荧幕前。

STREET FIGHTER, A 1994 live-action movie, should have been a crowning achievement for Capcom founder and film fan Kenzo Tsujimoto. Instead, the project was star-crossed from the beginning.

"Tsujimoto always aspired to get into the movie business, and with that project, he finally did it. But we learned a lot of lessons in the process," says Ian Rose, who was Capcom's general counsel in the early '90s. "There was no coherent strategy, nobody driving the creative process and making it adhere to the vision of the Japanese creators and designers. Everybody just kind of made up their own thing."

One of those surprising new directions was to make Guile, an American military hero, the central character. The decision was mostly based on casting: martial-arts action hero Jean-Claude Van Damme agreed to star in the movie,

so it made sense—vaguely—to bend the plot in the direction of Van Damme's character, rather than focusing on *Street Fighter II* mainstays such as Ryu, Ken and Chun-Li. Capcom's action-figure deal with toy-maker Hasbro helped Capcom's executives justify the plan: "There was this sense that if we were going to go with G.I. Joe versions of the characters, we could go army-themed with the movie, as well," says Rose.

The G.I. Joe figures weren't great. The movie was far worse. It drifted from *Street Fighter*'s martial-arts roots, instead attempting to land in a sort of James Bond-in-an-action-comedy zone. Its interpretations of the *Street Fighter* characters diverged greatly from the world warriors' in-game personas.

The movie still could have worked, at least on its own terms, considering that writer and director Steven de Souza was a star



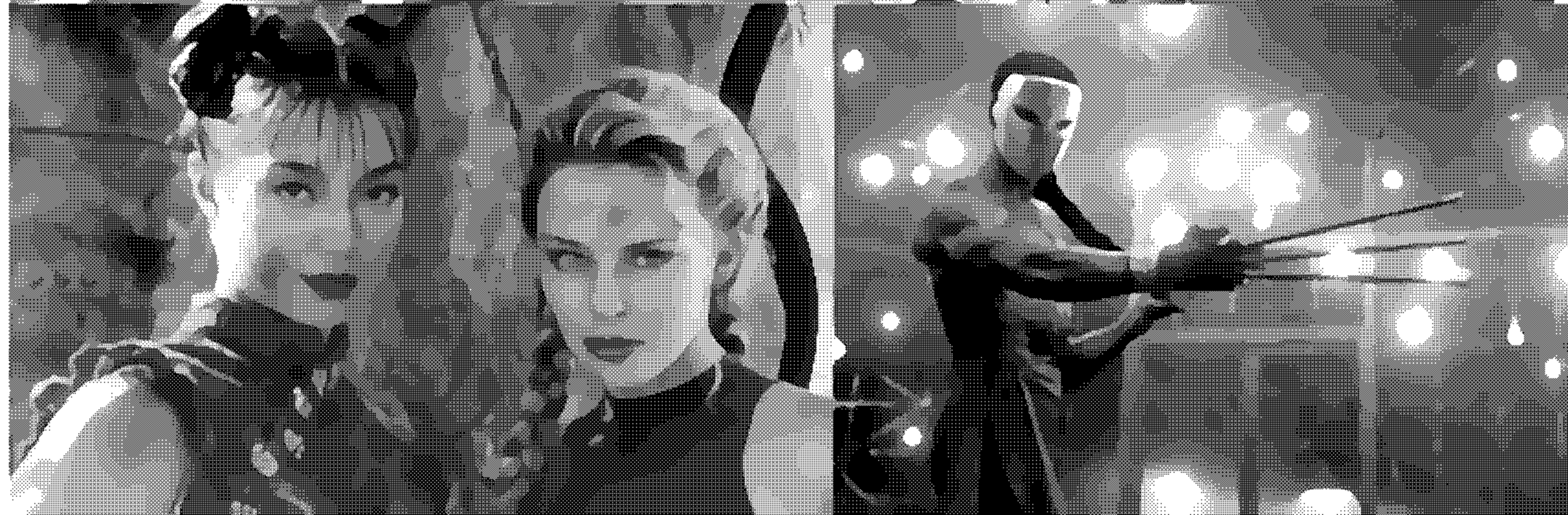
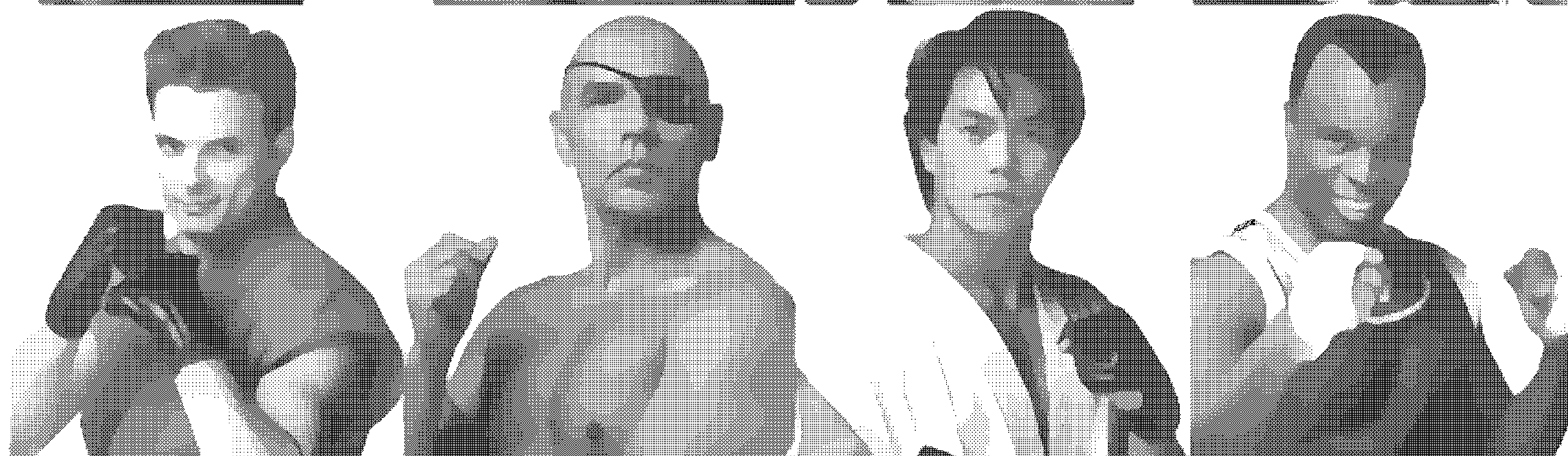


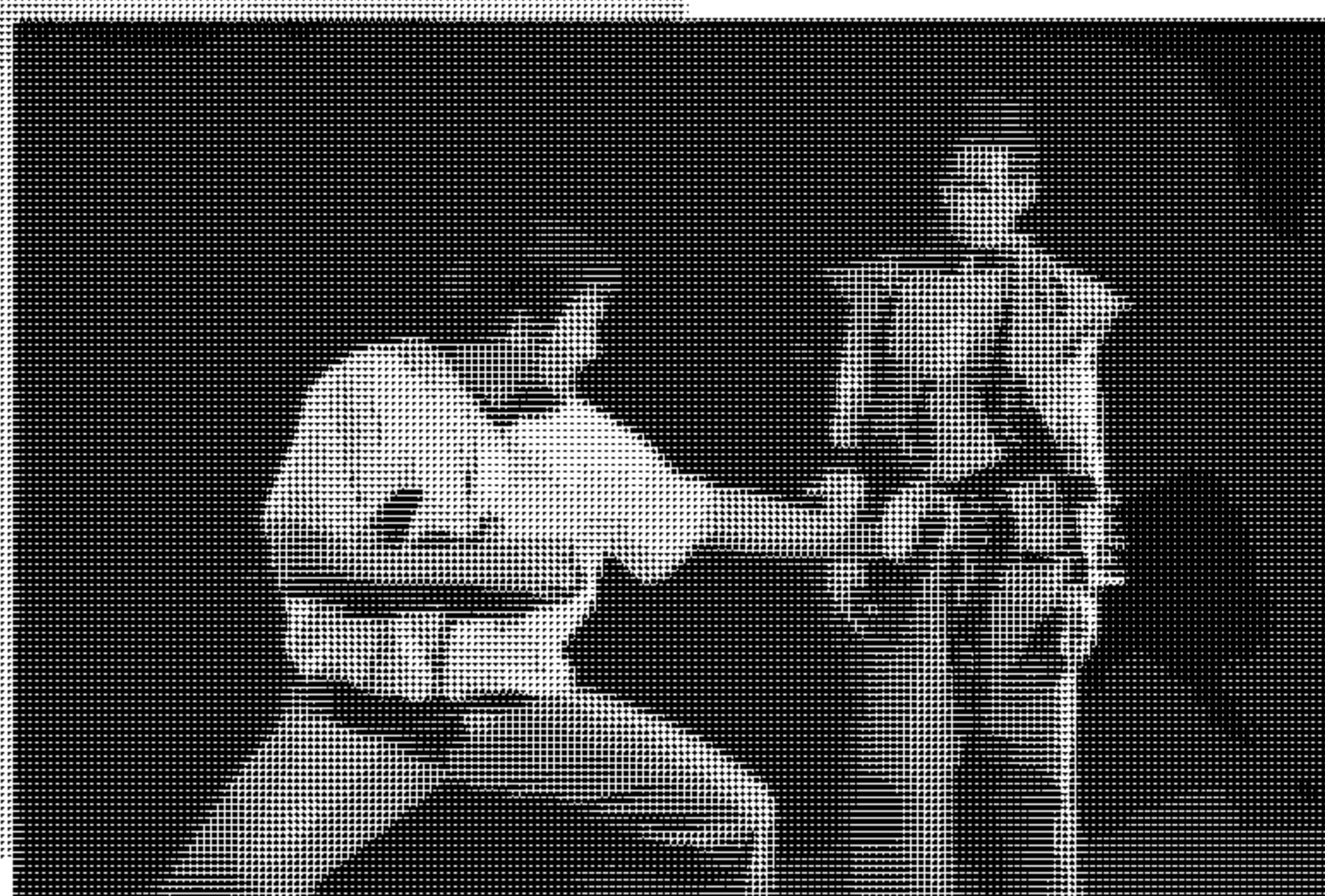
电影游离于《街头霸王》的武术基础,试图在詹姆斯邦德式的动作喜剧上立足。

右上:劳尔·朱力亚旁观导演史蒂文·苏扎指导尚格云顿;中下:《街头霸王》的演员还包括温明娜(饰春丽)和凯莉·米洛(饰嘉米)。

screenwriter whose credits included *Die Hard*, *The Running Man* and *48 Hrs*. But as a first-time director, de Souza was ill-equipped to deal with the madness on set. Van Damme had an affair with Australian co-star and pop-singer Kylie Minogue (Cammy). Raul Julia (M. Bison) was fighting stomach cancer—a disease that claimed his life before the movie's release. Finally, the sheer number of *Street Fighter* characters overwhelmed de Souza, who attempted to streamline his cast by turning Dhalsim into a meek scientist and combining Charlie Nash and Blanka into a single, unforgettable-for-the-wrong-reasons character called Carlos Blanka.

The resulting movie didn't land well with critics or audiences, though it did manage to gross \$100 million, thanks to the *Street Fighter* brand name.





《街头霸王电影版》游戏

AS STREET FIGHTER FILMED In Australia, Capcom worked on an interesting side project: a new game that used video-capture technology to turn the actors into playable characters. That approach had been employed by one of *Street Fighter*'s emerging rivals, the *Mortal Kombat* series produced by Midway Games in Chicago. To craft its own video-capture game, Capcom turned to Incredible Technologies, another Chicago-area game studio using similar digital tools.

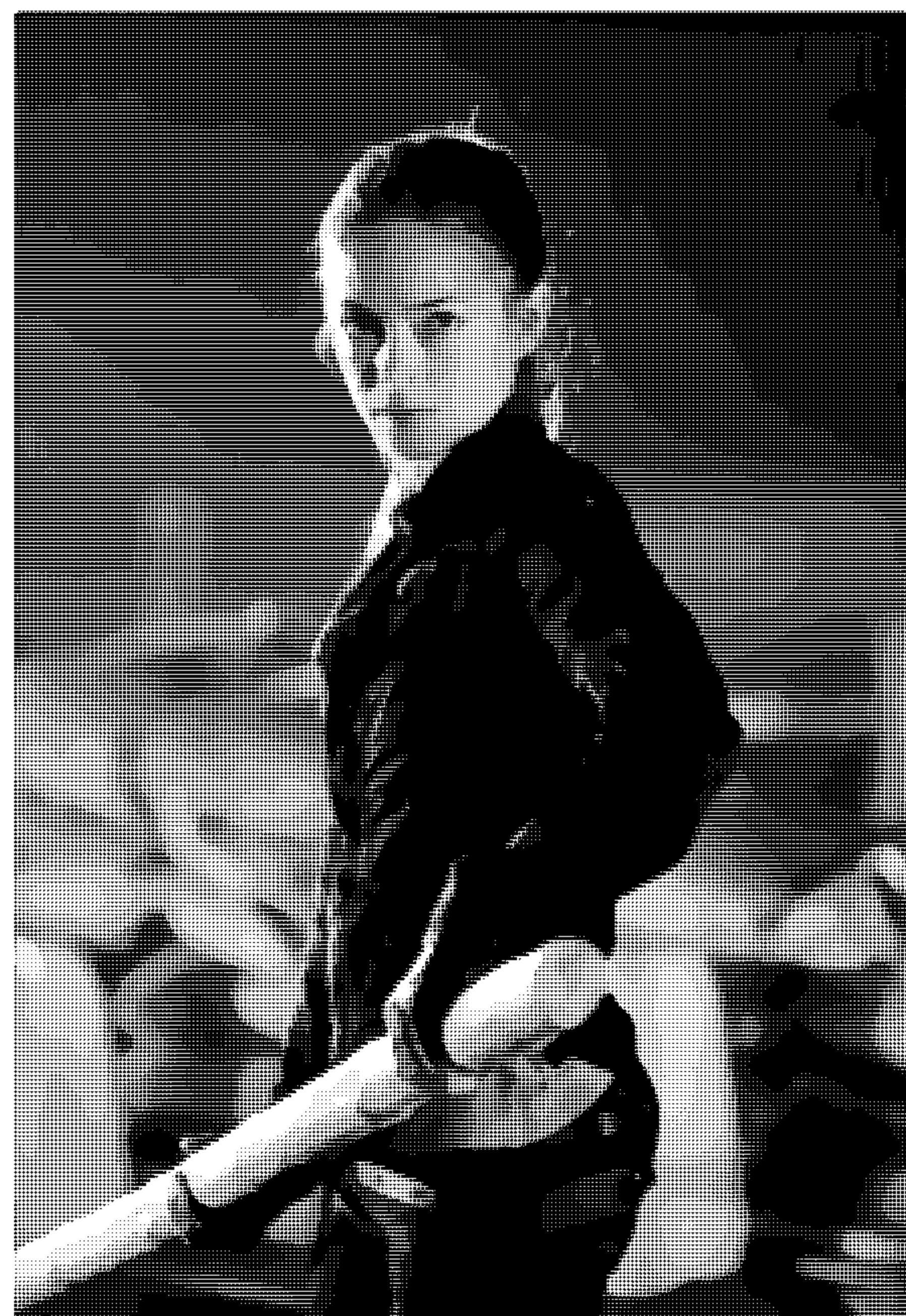
Incredible Technologies had its own hit series, *Golden Tee Golf*, and had also experimented with both fighting games and video-capture, though not at the same time. But when its team went to Australia to gather the video footage they needed to create their *Street Fighter: The Movie* game, they discovered that emerging technology was the least of their worries.

More pressing? First, several of the actors were holding out for more money and refused to show up for video-capture sessions. Second, when they did turn up, it became painfully apparent that they were thespians, not martial

artists. The exception was Van Damme.

"[Van Damme] cornered me in the makeup trailer—'You're one of the video game guys!'" remembers Ralph Melgosa, an Incredible Technologies game designer. "He wanted to know if we could add muscles to the other actors. He said, 'This game is going to fail if these guys don't look like heroes.'"

Van Damme may have looked like a hero when it was time to do his own video-capture work for the game, but when he arrived at the studio, he announced he would only be staying two hours, instead of the typical ten. He also wasn't particularly keen to do the required kicks, punches and special moves, until two of Melgosa's colleagues—one a *Street Fighter* fan and the other a Van Damme expert—figured out a workaround. They determined which moves from other Van Damme movies looked the most like what they needed for the *Street Fighter* game, then asked him to show off his greatest hits. This time, Van Damme happily obliged. "We just sat there stroking his ego until he'd given us all the moves," recalls Melgosa.



街头霸王:春丽传

第二次真人电影的尝试 导致了第二次失误

IN 2009, DIRECTOR ANDRZEJ Bartkowiak tried again to turn a famous cast and a big budget into a *Street Fighter* box-office hit. His film, *Street Fighter: The Legend of Chun-Li*, is better than *Street Fighter*—but that's not saying much, and the film failed to connect with audiences. Kristen Kreuk (best known for her role on the TV series *Smallville*) stars as Chun-Li, while Neal McDonough portrays M. Bison as a maniacal real-estate developer who will stop at nothing in his nefarious bid to gentrify the coastal slums of Bangkok. Chun-Li prevails, no thanks to the least-compelling Spinning Bird Kick imaginable.

A动画IN

《街头霸王》'天然的栖身之地

《街头霸王II》动画电影的剧情主要是M.拜森对青的洗脑,拜森成功地驱使青去对付隆——暂时的,剪辑动画的工作室也剪辑了电影。

created by Japanese anime studio Group TAC and director Gisaburō Sugii. A year after the movie's release, in the fall of 1995, Sugii adapted *Street Fighter* for Japanese TV with *Street Fighter II V*, a 29-episode anime series; in the U.S., a different animated television series called *Street Fighter* hewed closely to the Guile-dominated world outlined in the Van Damme movie, and produced 26 episodes between 1995 and 1997.

Group TAC released its next *Street Fighter* movie in 1999 with *Street Fighter Alpha: The Animation*, this time with Shigeyasu Yamauchi directing in place of Sugii. The film culminated with a familiar scene: *Street Fighter*'s world warriors gathered in one place, challenged to defeat the sinister designs of an evil mastermind. But it also devoted a lot of time to Ryu's and Ken's training at Gouken's dojo, and to Ryu's struggle to overcome the murderous impulses within him—the same conflict that ultimately consumed Akuma, another practitioner of Ansatsusken martial arts.

The exploration of this plot line from the *Alpha* games would emerge as one of the most potent in the *Street Fighter* universe, and drive some of the best *Street Fighter* storytelling of recent years, including Udon's graphic novel *Street Fighter Origins: Akuma* and animated comic *Street Fighter: Round One - Fight!*, as well as serialized live-action film *Street Fighter: Assassin's Fist*.

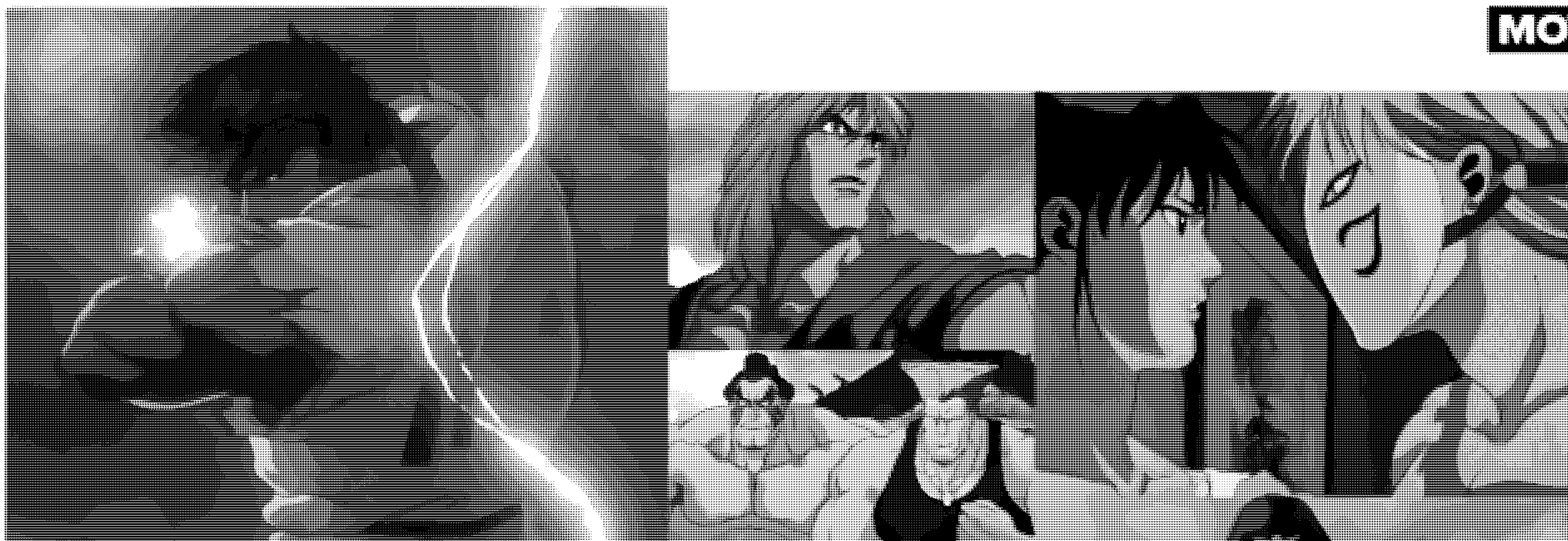
In 2005, *Street Fighter Alpha: Generations*, directed by Ikuo Kuwana and created by animation studio A.P.P.P., took the series' origin story a step further by devoting much of its narrative to the childhood of Gouken and his brother—the wayward warrior who eventually became Akuma.

Since the arrival of *Street Fighter IV*, Capcom has released a series of animated films more directly related to its games. *Street Fighter IV: The Ties That Bind*, for example, was released as part of a *Street Fighter IV* collector's edition, and *Street Fighter V* showcased a feature-length, animated story mode called *A Shadow Falls*.

AT THE SAME TIME Capcom was making its first big-budget, live-action *Street Fighter* movie in the United States, it was pursuing a very different silver-screen strategy in Japan: an animated feature film. *Street Fighter II: The Animated Movie* hit Japanese theaters in the fall of 1994, a few months before the release of Jean-Claude Van Damme's *Street Fighter*.

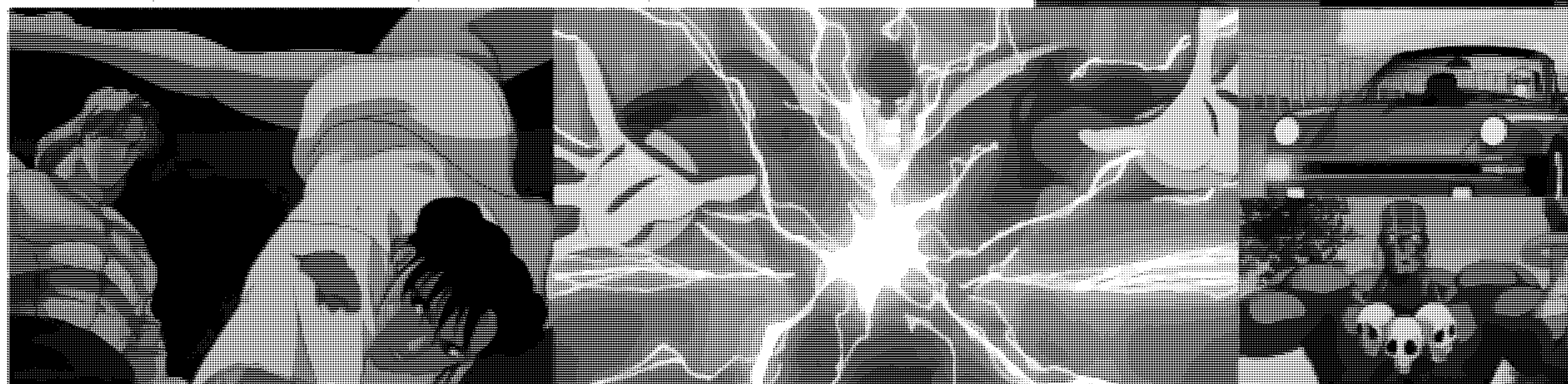
Street Fighter II: The Animated Movie was driven by a garden-variety M. Bison world-domination scheme, but the characters looked and felt true to their game-world selves, with Ryu and Ken at the center of the action. The plot hinged on whether Ken could shake off Bison's hypnotic control in time to save the world, but the movie's most jarring moment was an R-rated extended take of Chun-Li in the shower, followed by a vicious, surprise attack from Vega. It's weird to see the powerful Chun-Li portrayed as a Janet Leigh-style shower-slasher victim; at least she redeemed herself in the subsequent fight, taking out Vega before Guile arrived to save her.

Street Fighter II: The Animated Movie was



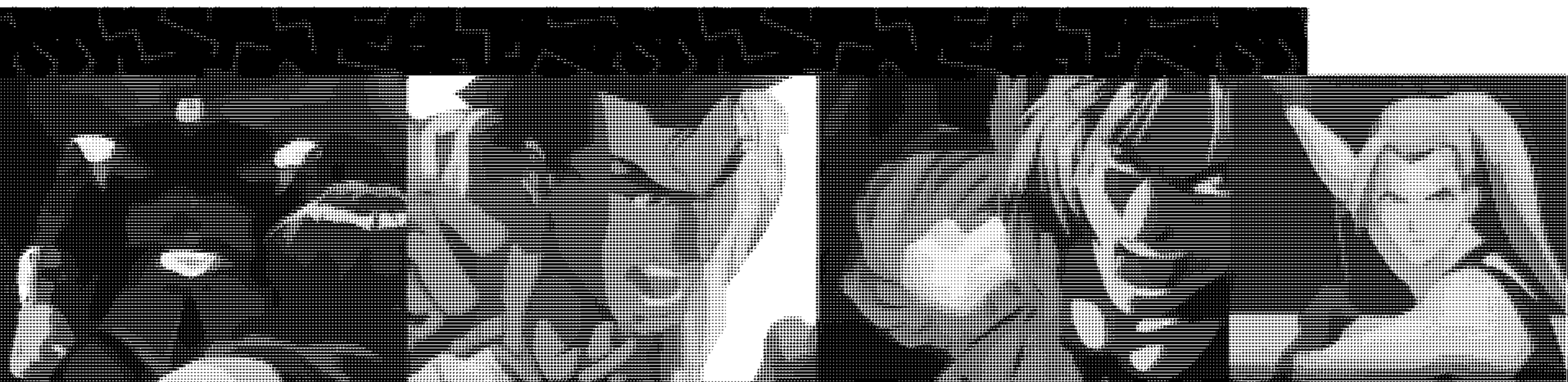
《街头霸王II》动画电影(1994)

杉井仪三郎导演的这部电影确立了《街头霸王II》的世界及人物,可它最难忘的一段却是春丽冲澡并被攻击的画面.影片抓住了《街头霸王》的整体理念以及90年代早期的人文精神.在某个片段中,肯身穿连帽卫衣,听着垃圾摇滚,开车漫游西雅图.



《街头霸王》电视动画

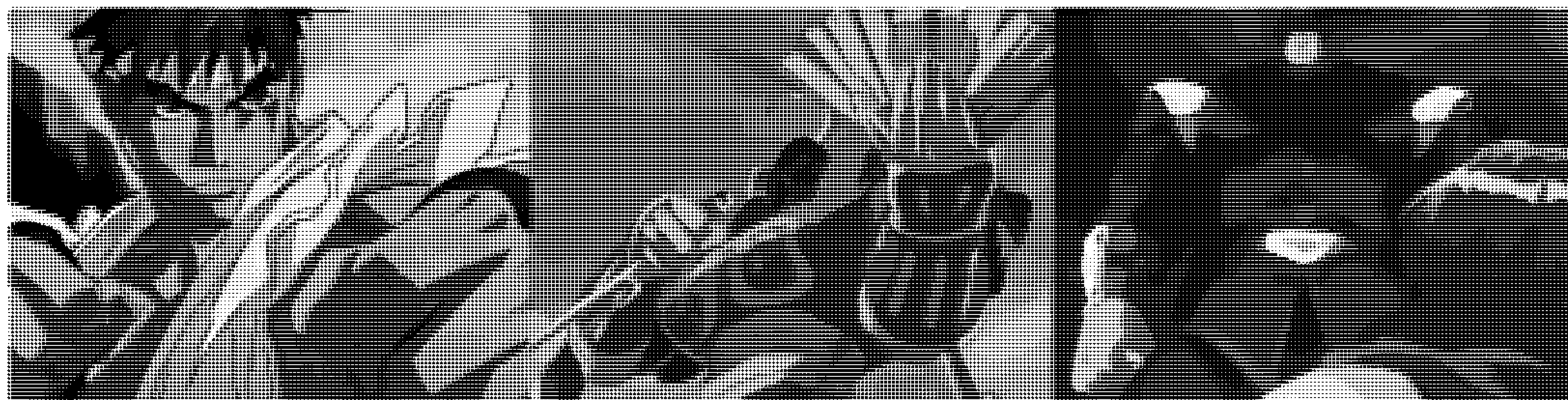
日本电视动画《街头霸王II-V字》是由《街头霸王II》动画电影的同一工作室,同一导演出品的,而美国卡通《街头霸王》则坚守着尚格云顿真人电影所描绘的世界.



上一行:日本电视动画《街头霸王II-V字》画面;下一行:美国卡通《街头霸王》画面.

《街头霸王α》动画电影(2000)

这部电影首次将隆对抗心魔的挣扎搬上银幕。一个自称是隆弟弟的声音催促他屈服于吞噬豪鬼的那种黑暗力量,但隆还是及时恢复过来挽救了局面。



“对,隆,感受更多的愤怒!感受更多的憎恨!如此简单的陷阱,而你和你朋友们都将落入其中!”



隆的声音

小杉健(美籍日裔)是通过玩《街头霸王II》学的日语,而后来为隆配了音。

FOR KANE KOSUGI, who played Ryu in *Street Fighter Alpha: The Animation*, the film represented a chance to portray a character who had special resonance for him. Kosugi is the son of Sho Kosugi—the martial-arts movie star who inspired *Street Fighter* character Guy. Kane followed his father to Japan after finishing high school in California, and his first days in that country involved a lot of *Street Fighter*.

“It was hard at first to go to a different country without friends, and where I hadn't mastered the language. I was 18 and living by myself, and at first, every day, all day, I would stay at home and play *Street Fighter II*,” says Kosugi.

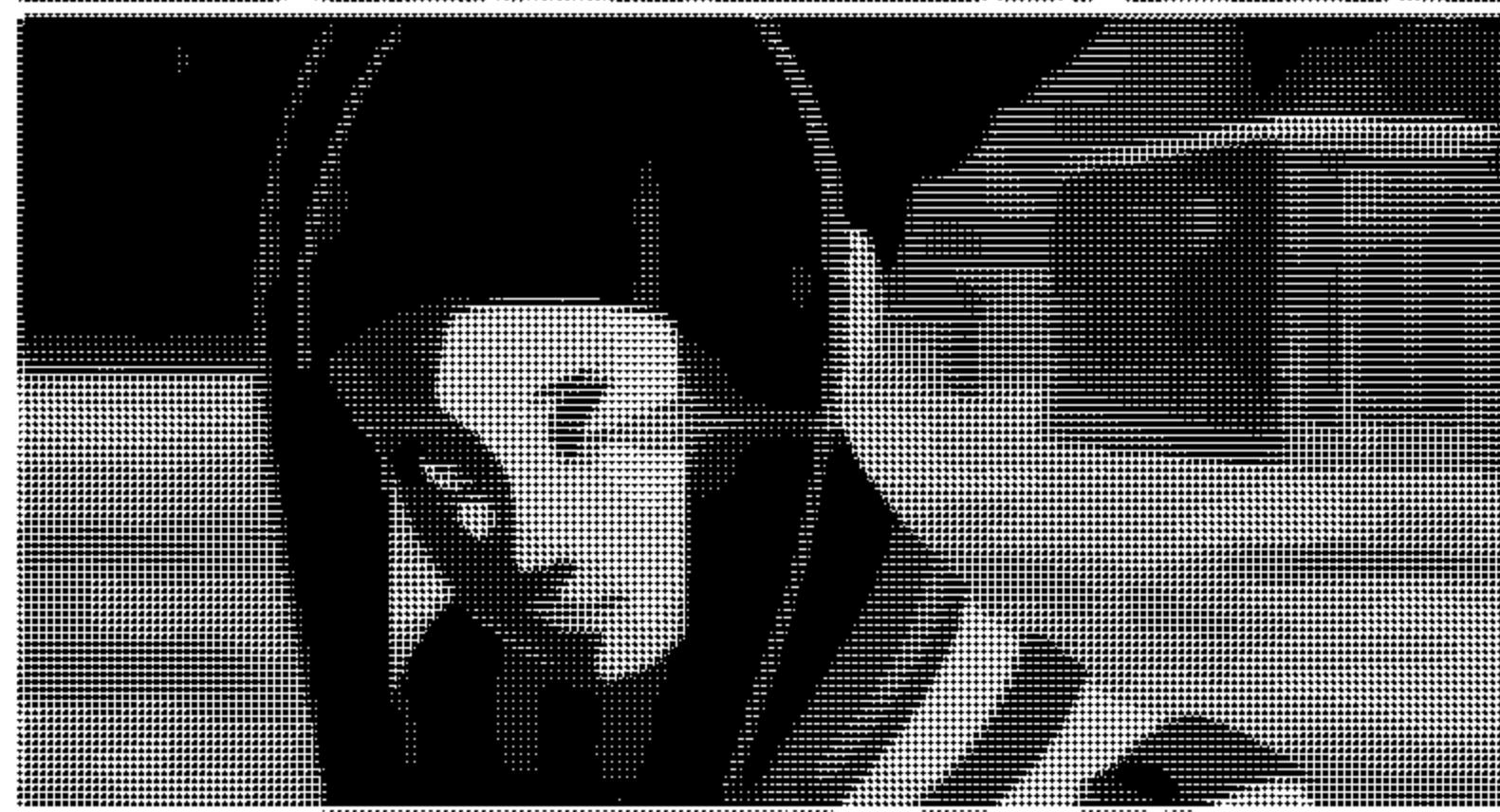
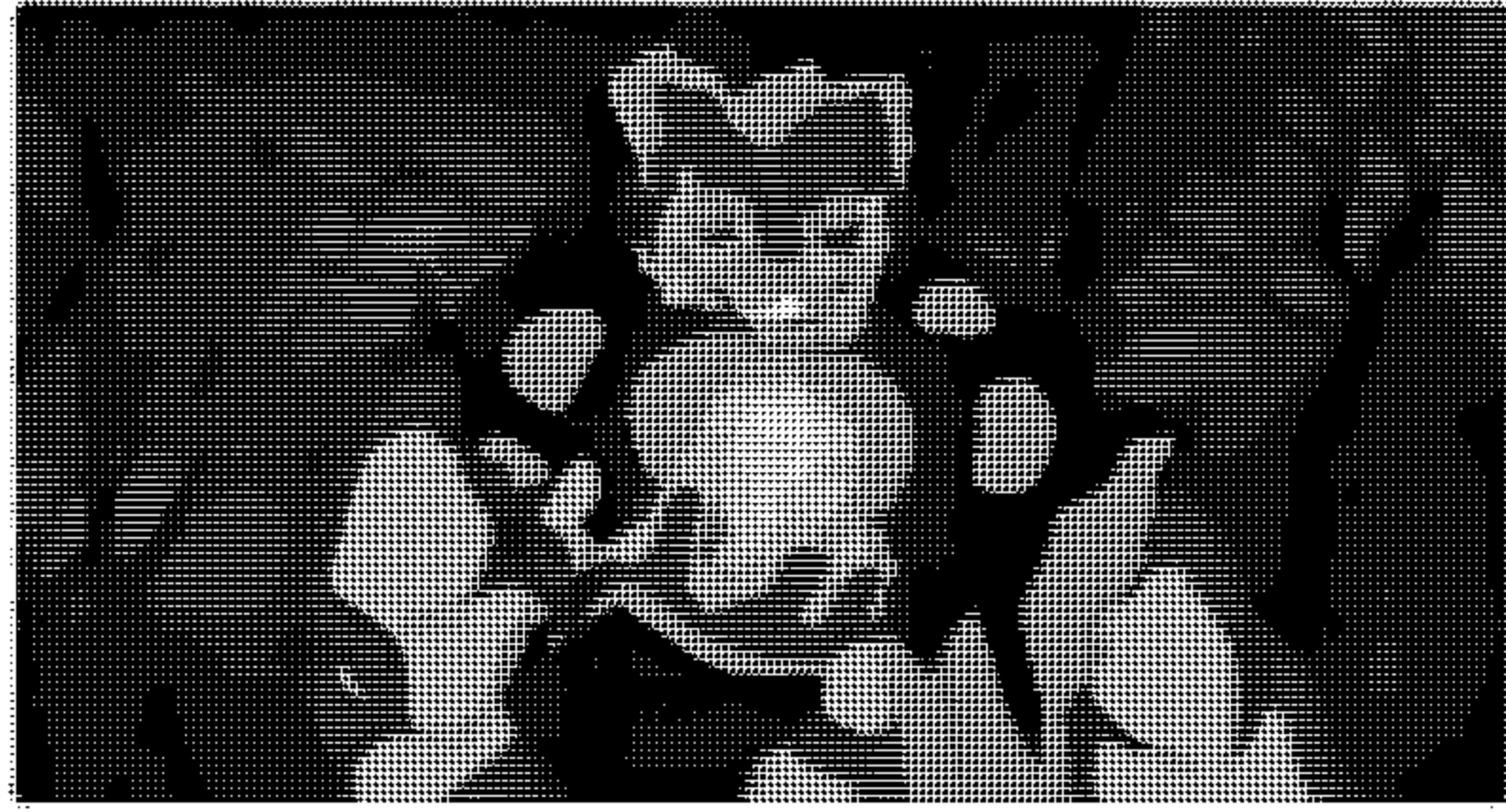
He was also training to be a martial artist, so Kosugi used Ryu to learn new moves—and also to refine his knowledge of Japanese. “I would try to mimic the video games, to see if I could pick up any hints from how the fighters moved. Ryu was a character I really enjoyed studying,” he says. “And yes—I learned Japanese from playing *Street Fighter II* and watching *Dragon Ball*.”

Street Fighter Alpha: The Animation was a unique project for Kosugi because he voice-acted Ryu in the Japanese version of the movie, even though he was still more comfortable with English at the time. Still, the degree of difficulty was nothing compared to the live-action martial-arts films for which he's best known.

“Animated films are fun because you're not tired from doing all the action,” he says.

《街头霸王α:世代》(2005)

这个故事集中于钢拳(隆的师父)和他弟弟豪鬼(最终投身杀意的不羁战士)的童年。



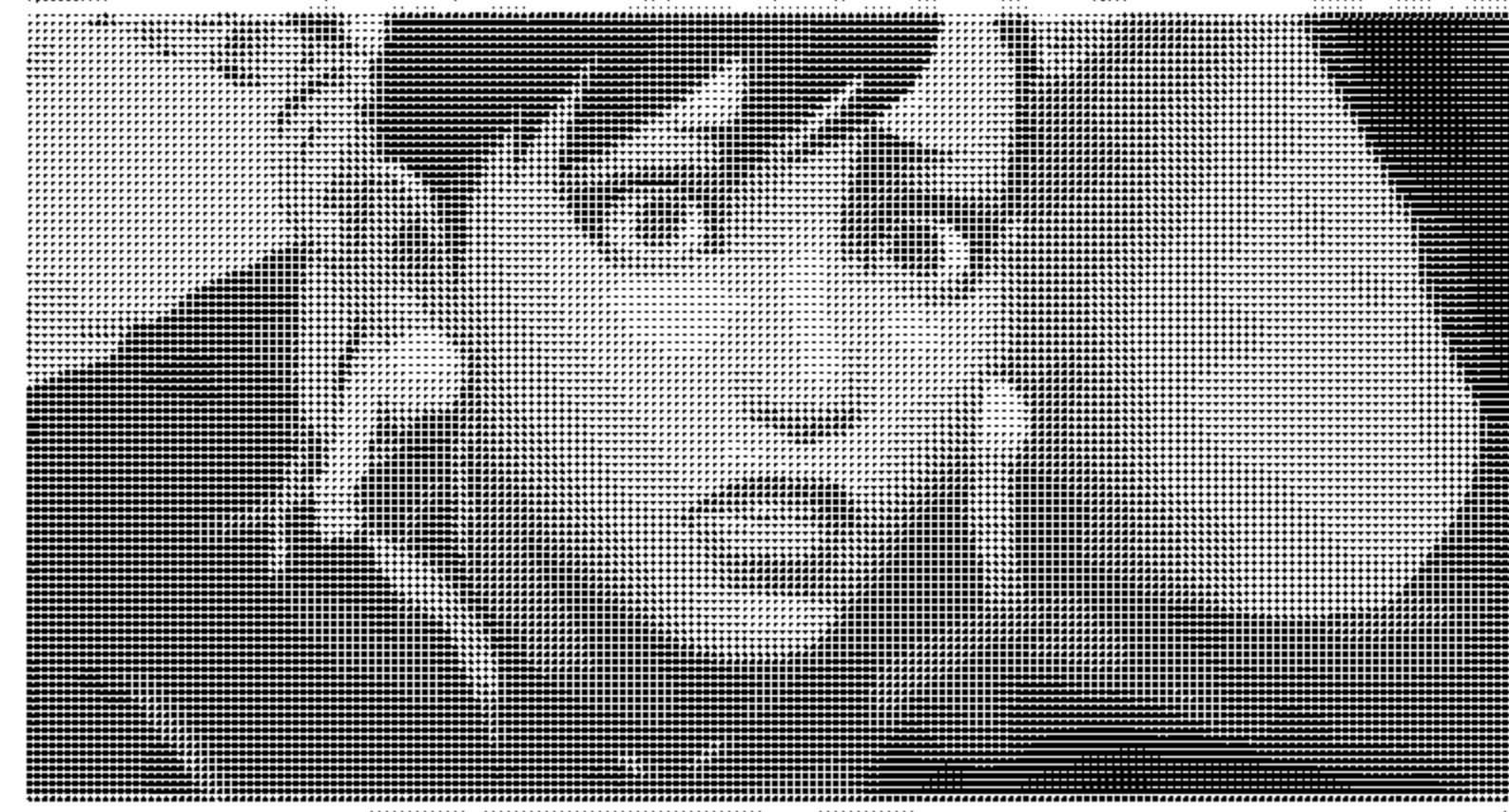
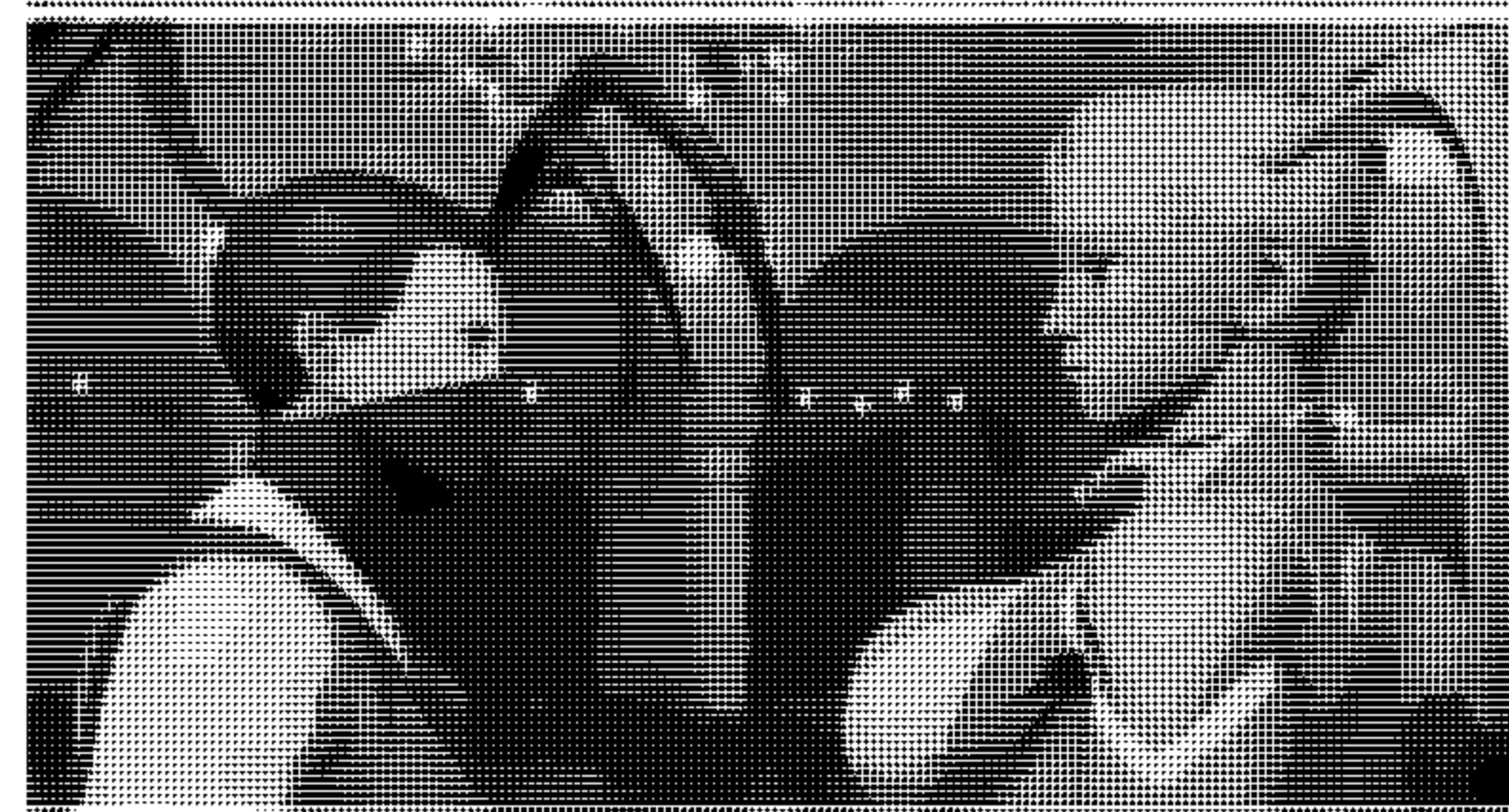
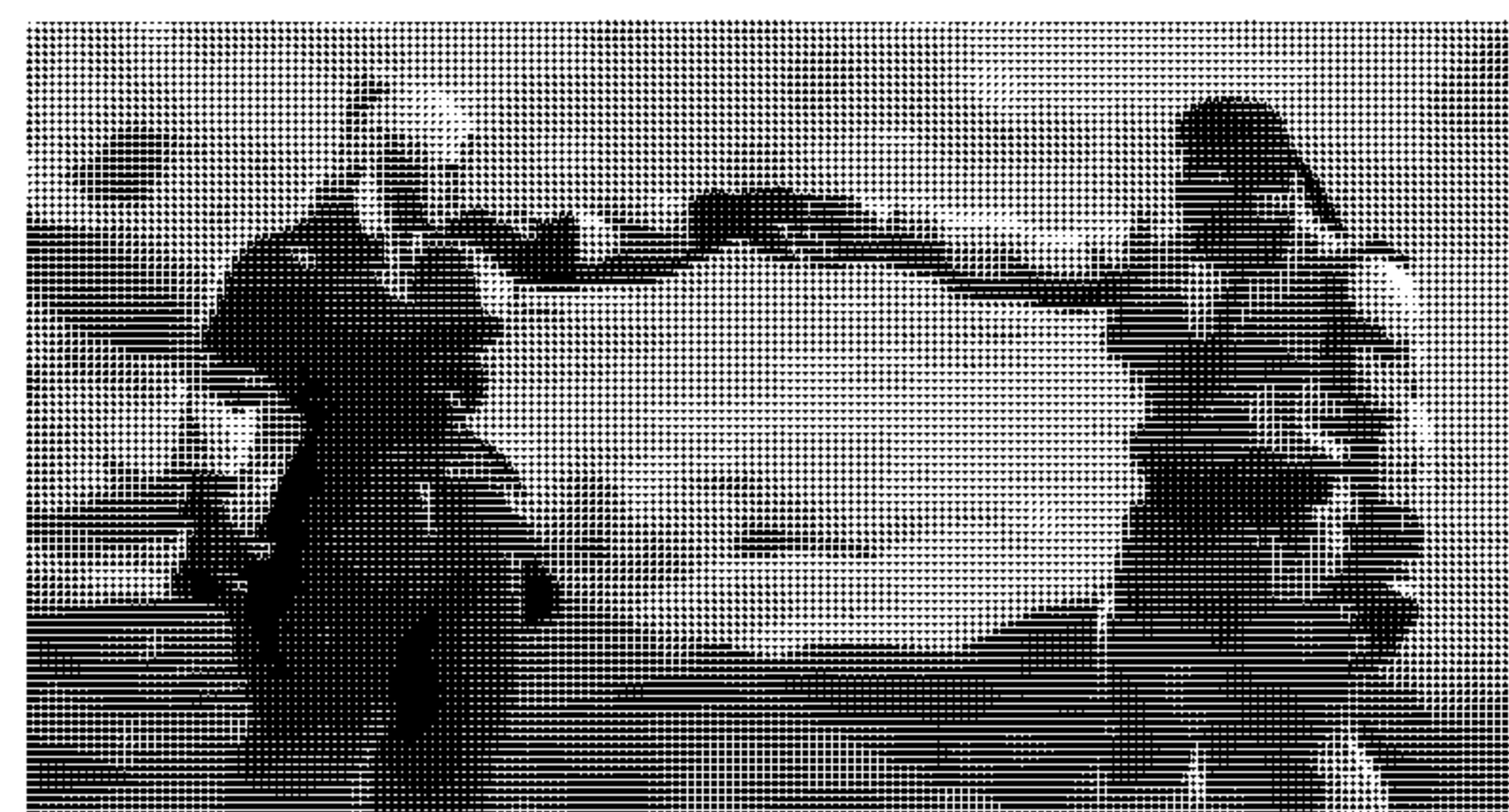
《街头霸王IV:新的羁绊》

和《超级街头霸王IV》

这些动画电影是跟随游戏《街头霸王4》典藏版(2008)和《超级街头霸王IV》(2010)发布的。

《街头霸王V:阴影降临》(2016)

《阴影降临》是《街头霸王V》的长篇故事模式,由需操控的格斗与延伸剧情片段交替组成。





真人电影也有效果

2014年的《暗杀拳》展示了《街头霸王》电影的潜质

THE FIRST LIVE-ACTION STREET Fighter movie to win widespread fan approval was 2014's serialized film *Street Fighter: Assassin's Fist*, created by the team of Joey Ansah and Christian Howard. The two co-wrote the story and also had key roles: Ansah directed and played Akuma, while Howard portrayed Ken. The film traces the origins of Ryu, Ken and Akuma as they train in a mountainous dojo in Japan, drawing from narrative elements in the *Street Fighter Alpha: Generations* anime, along with bits from Udon's comics and the *Street Fighter* games.

The film succeeds thanks to great storytelling and action choreography (both Ansah and Howard are terrific martial artists), as well as the thoughtful attention given to the

source material. Ryu, Ken, Akuma and sensei Gouken are portrayed in a manner that seemed true to their characters' personas and fighting styles.

In 2016, Ansah and Howard released four episodes of a followup series called *Street Fighter Resurrection*, focused on plot elements from *Street Fighter V*.



克里斯蒂安·霍华德与迈克·莫分别扮演肯和隆。岳·斯比斯扮演青年豪鬼,而乔伊·安沙的怒视刻画出了中年豪鬼的恶念。



该电影追溯了隆、肯及豪鬼的出身,他们都在日本的一座山中道场里训练.





《街头霸王》短命的首部漫画

马里布的《街头霸王》连载了三集—可对肯来说就太漫长了

COMIC-BOOK WRITER LEN STRAZEWSKI saw *Street Fighter*'s potential right away. *Street Fighter II* was already a runaway hit game in 1993, when California publisher Malibu Comics hired him to write *Street Fighter* comics. *Street Fighter*'s blending of martial-arts movie tropes and superhero stories only added to the appeal, considering he loved both genres.

Capcom's U.S. office had given Strazewski a thin set of background materials, sketching the worlds of Ryu and of crime syndicate Shadaloo, but only as the barest of narrative suggestions, gleaned from game manuals and arcade-mode endings. It was enough to get Strazewski interested.

"The game characters were very compelling from a comic book standpoint," Strazewski recalls. "They each had unique moves that were a lot like superpowers, and the backstory was quite good, with strong ideas and conflicts."

Right away, he zeroed in on the genre-bending inherent in *Street Fighter*'s universe: the combination of traditional martial-arts story elements such as Ryu's quest for tournament glory, along with action-blockbuster tropes like M. Bison's plans for world domination.

"I wanted to tell a dramatic, international espionage story that had some of the flavor of the martial-arts movie tradition," recalls Strazewski, who crafted a 12-issue storyline to do just that. The central thread was Ryu's quest for vengeance. "Almost always in martial-arts movies, the plot goes like this: a bad thing happens; someone seeks revenge or retribution; and then to achieve it, they have to work their way through a series of battles or challenges. I needed a way for Ryu to be motivated to go after these people."

That step seemed simple enough. Strazewski just had to identify something dear to Ryu, and take it away from him.

So he killed Ken.

Not permanently, Strazewski insists. But he killed him and even scalped him—a plot twist that Capcom's licensing team reviewed and approved.

"This was a catalyst, something dramatic early in the storyline that motivates extreme action," Strazewski says. "But no one ever really dies in comic books, so I always planned to bring him back—he would be found alive, working undercover for the CIA, or have an evil twin, or be cloned in Bison's secret laboratories."

But Strazewski never got the chance. Malibu's *Street Fighter* series was cancelled after three issues, meaning Strazewski still has Ken's death on his hands. Strazewski is now a professor at Columbia College in Chicago, and a few years ago the college provost introduced him at a gallery opening: "You all know Len," the speech began, "but many of you don't know he's a murderer."



史崔瑞乌斯基要找到隆所珍视的东西并夺走它.于是他杀了肯.

左上:马里布的首本《街头霸王》封面;右上:中平正彦漫画《格斗少女樱》中引入了卡琳;右下:伊东麻美(黑白)漫画《街头霸王外传》一瞥.



卡琳的诞生

Japanese artist and author Masahiko Nakahira produced four *Street Fighter* manga during the 1990s. His titles ranged in tone from the grim, serious *Ryu Fined* to the playful *Sakura Gambol*. The latter title has a special distinction in *Street Fighter* lore because it introduces the character of Karin Kasumi, Sakura's ultra-rich arch-rival. Capcom adopted Karin as a playable character and she has appeared in *Street Fighter Alpha 3* as well as *Street Fighter V*. Nakahira is one of three Japanese mangaka who created *Street Fighter* series in the 1990s. The others were Masamichi Kusanagi, who authored the three-volume *Street Fighter II: Rival* series, and Masao Imai, whose collection of short stories was released in the U.S. as *Street Fighter Golden*.



从狂热粉丝到故事作者

乌冬公寓的艺术家们如何创作《街头霸王》漫画



STREET FIGHTER'S BEST-KNOWN AND longest-running series of comics began as a stylistic dispute within a Toronto comics publisher called Dreamwave. The company's founders, brothers Pat and Roger Lee, favored an anime-inspired aesthetic. But a handful of Dreamwave's most promising young artists had fallen in love with Capcom's hybrid style that married characteristics of Japanese animation, such as exaggerated, emotive facial characteristics, and Western elements such as pinpoint anatomical accuracy.

"Those Capcom designs were very unique and special and different, and the people creating them were art gods compared to other game designers," says Erik Ko, the leader of the faction of Capcom devotees.

In 2000, a group of Dreamwave artists broke away from the company and established Udon Entertainment as a creative-services agency and comics publisher, setting up shop in Ko's basement. Many of the young artists literally moved in, and began living and working together in a sort of comic-book commune. They called their new home the Udon Mansion.

Right away, the group set its sights on Street Fighter comics. As a small-time studio, Ko figured he didn't have the resources to procure the license on his own, so he attempted to broker a deal through a third-party publisher. But in those dark ages of Street Fighter—the nadir of the series' popularity—no one was interested.

Just before giving up, however, the Udon team had an idea: If no one else was bidding on Street Fighter, then perhaps the license wouldn't be so expensive, after all. Ko made a bid, including concept sketches. Udon won the contract.

"That was a marquee moment in my career. I just never thought it would be possible," says Alvin Lee, one of the young Udon artists who lived in the mansion. "We got to draw all the stuff we had looked up to for so many years. And I think our love for that style of art and those artists showed through in our approach to the comic books. We tried to honor the originals as much as we could, while also putting our own spin on it."

The resulting comics featured work by Udon artists such as Lee, Arnold Tsang, Jeffrey Cruz and Omar Dogan. The stories not only brought Street Fighter's world to life in a figurative way, but renewed interest in the series—helping to bring back Capcom's tired flagship in a very real sense.

Ko's crew of young Toronto artists went on to influence game series beyond Street Fighter, as well. Tsang is now the lead character-concept artist on the game *Overwatch*, while Lee works as principal artist on *League of Legends*. Ko and the Udon team, meanwhile, continue to produce Street Fighter titles, including a new series that pits Ryu and company against another set of Capcom fighting-game heroes, the Darkstalkers.

左图:《街头霸王:伊吹传奇》中,新生艾琳娜向同学们问好。

2000年,一群艺术家脱离(多伦多漫画出版商)Dreamwave,自己组建了乌冬娱乐公司。许多年轻艺术家直接搬进了公司,像某种漫画公社那样一起工作,一起生活。他们把自己的新家称为"乌冬公寓"。

黑暗的新一章

乌冬的最新漫画是对卡普空格斗游戏的混搭

UDON'S 14-YEAR RUN OF *Street Fighter* publishing has included an extensive collection of standalone comics and graphic novels that run the gamut in terms of tone and subject matter. The diverse range of storytelling possibilities is part of what endears *Street Fighter* to the Udon crew.

"There's such a wide scope to explore," says Matt Moylan, Udon's director of publishing. "You can tell the serious martial-arts story or the action-packed, save-the-world story, or even the silly, goofy story. They all tie together through the passion that these characters have for fighting—whether they're driven by money or fun or justice or to better themselves. It's allowed us to go to some very dark places, such as when we looked at Akuma and why he's willing to kill people. But we can also tell a story where the climax is a hot-dog eating contest."

Udon's latest *Street Fighter* foray imagines the interrelationships among *Street Fighter*'s world warriors and the underworld pugilists from Capcom's *Darkstalkers* games. For writer Ken Siu-Chong, the process of forcibly colliding two of Capcom's animated worlds has been deeply satisfying.

"The first time I had Akuma share a scene with the *Darkstalkers* characters, it seemed so natural that I couldn't believe it hadn't been done before."

The idea came from the conclusion to Siu-Chong's *Street Fighter Unlimited* series, in which Ryu uses both light and dark power to defeat the villainous overlord Gill. Siu-Chong wanted Ryu to defeat Gill, but then be banished to an underworld. Suddenly it occurred to him that it could be the same world occupied by the *Darkstalkers*.

"It's worked out so perfectly. I'm not forcing anything; it feels like these universes have coexisted all along," Siu-Chong says.

What's harder for Siu-Chong to wrap his mind around is the notion that he is helping to shape the same fictional world that he once admired as a player and fan.

"It's like a childhood dream to put my stamp on this universe," he says.

乌冬娱乐的年轻艺术家们还在影响着《街头霸王》以外的游戏系列。阿诺德·曾(美籍华裔)现在是《守望先锋》的主角概念艺术设计师,而李则是《英雄联盟》的首席设计师。



乌冬最新系列《街头霸王大战恶魔战士》让世界勇士们去对抗卡普空的魔界战士。

龍馬

龍馬

THE



THE BIG COMEBACK

起死回生

00年代对于格斗游戏爱好者来说，是贫乏的十年。就连生机勃勃的锦标赛也抵不过新游戏的缺失。《街头霸王》的时代几乎就要结束了，但玩家们却听说了传闻：一款以旧角色为主的新游戏即将推出一——这传闻不仅是真的，而且为《街头霸王》及其粉丝们预告了一个全新的黄金时代。

随，肯及《街头霸王II》人物在2008年的《街头霸王IV》中卷土重来，也有少数新面孔加入。(插画由池野大悟绘制)



没有了街机厅或新的《街头霸王》游戏，格斗游戏社群在渐渐消亡。



《街头霸王》明星贾斯汀·王在纽约城传奇般的唐人街街机厅成年。这个街机厅在2015年的纪录片《失落的街机厅》中也出现过。

濒临死亡的《街头霸王》

新游戏的缺乏和街机厅的衰亡差点抹杀了《街头霸王》社群

SOUTHERN HILLS GOLFLAND, THE unofficial home of Street Fighter in Southern California, closed its doors in 2002. The property was sold to developers and the arcade torn down; two dozen homes were built in its place.

John Bailon, the arcade's legendary manager, stayed until the bitter end and still lives nearby. Until Southern Hills' final days, the close-knit community of Street Fighter diehards, led by Alex Valle, would play Street Fighter every night until the arcade's 1 a.m. closing, then grab food at a nearby all-night diner. When the arcade finally shuttered, it felt like the group had lost its home.

The Southern Hills players tried to recapture that magic at nearby arcades like Camelot Golfland in Anaheim. What they found was a harsh truth: their days as kings of the arcade had come and gone.

"We'd go to the manager at Camelot to

say the stick was broken, and he'd tell us it would be a couple hours before he could fix it because he was taking care of a pizza party," remembers Art Mkhikian, one of the regulars.

The players weren't getting any love from Capcom, either. The company had moved on from Street Fighter. For all the success of its landmark 1990s series, it was clear to Capcom's leadership that the new millennium was ushering in a different era of gaming, one that didn't accommodate Street Fighter's shoulder-to-shoulder, player-versus-player ethos. Arcades were dying. Online play was still an imaginary, futuristic concept like smartphones and streaming video. And there were plenty of other opportunities for Capcom to pursue, thanks to series such as Resident Evil, Devil May Cry and Monster Hunter that were better suited to the home-console era.

For a while, the competitive Street Fighter

scene persisted. Tom and Tony Cannon, the twin brothers and Stanford students who had organized the 1996 tournament in Sunnyvale, parlayed the success of that first tournament into an annual event in Las Vegas called the Evolution Championship Series, or EVO. As they built EVO, they partnered with their old newsgroup rival Seth Killian from the University of Illinois, as well as a Southern California player named Joey Cuellar. Cuellar tried to infuse the tournaments with the spirit of Southern Hills Golfland.

"John Bailon believed that 'if you build it, they will come,' and that's exactly what happened at Southern Hills. It became the place where the top players played, and then because of that, other players would travel in from all over," says Cuellar. "We took the same philosophy with EVO: If you build the right stage, people will come to play and show off their best stuff."



The tournaments grew quickly in the early 2000s, and while older players like Valle and John Choi took a step back from the competitive scene, they were replaced by a generation of extraordinary gaming talents such as Japan's Daigo Umehara, Britain's Ryan Hart and New Yorker Justin Wong. The 2004 EVO match in which Umehara bested Wong with an impossible comeback remains one of e-sports' best-known, defining moments. Umehara's Chun-Li, down to the smallest imaginable sliver of life, parried what seemed a million consecutive attacks from Wong's Ken before delivering a knockout blow and sending thousands of spectators into a frenzy.

But without arcades to draw the community together, or new Street Fighter games to capture players' imaginations, the fighting-game community's momentum gradually faded. By 2008, Wong figured it was dying out. He wasn't even going to bother attending EVO.

在南山(街机厅)最后的日子里,与它紧密相连的《街头霸王》死忠们随艾利克斯·巴列一起,每晚玩《街头霸王》玩到凌晨一点街机厅关门。

2002年,南山区高尔夫兰(街机厅)的常客们纪念历史性的最后一天(中间左二为街机厅老板约翰·拜尔仑)。



再度归来的准备工作

小野义德令休眠的系列重生了

INSIDE CAPCOM, STREET FIGHTER was dead and buried. The series had anchored a golden era for the company, but that era had passed. During the 2000s, even as the moderate successes of Udon's Street Fighter comics and SOTA Toys' action figures demonstrated fans' ongoing loyalty to the series, there were no plans to resurrect it. The only reason the topic even came up in 2006 is that Sony announced its next-generation console, the PlayStation 3, and a Capcom producer suggested that a Street Fighter nostalgia game might make for an interesting project.

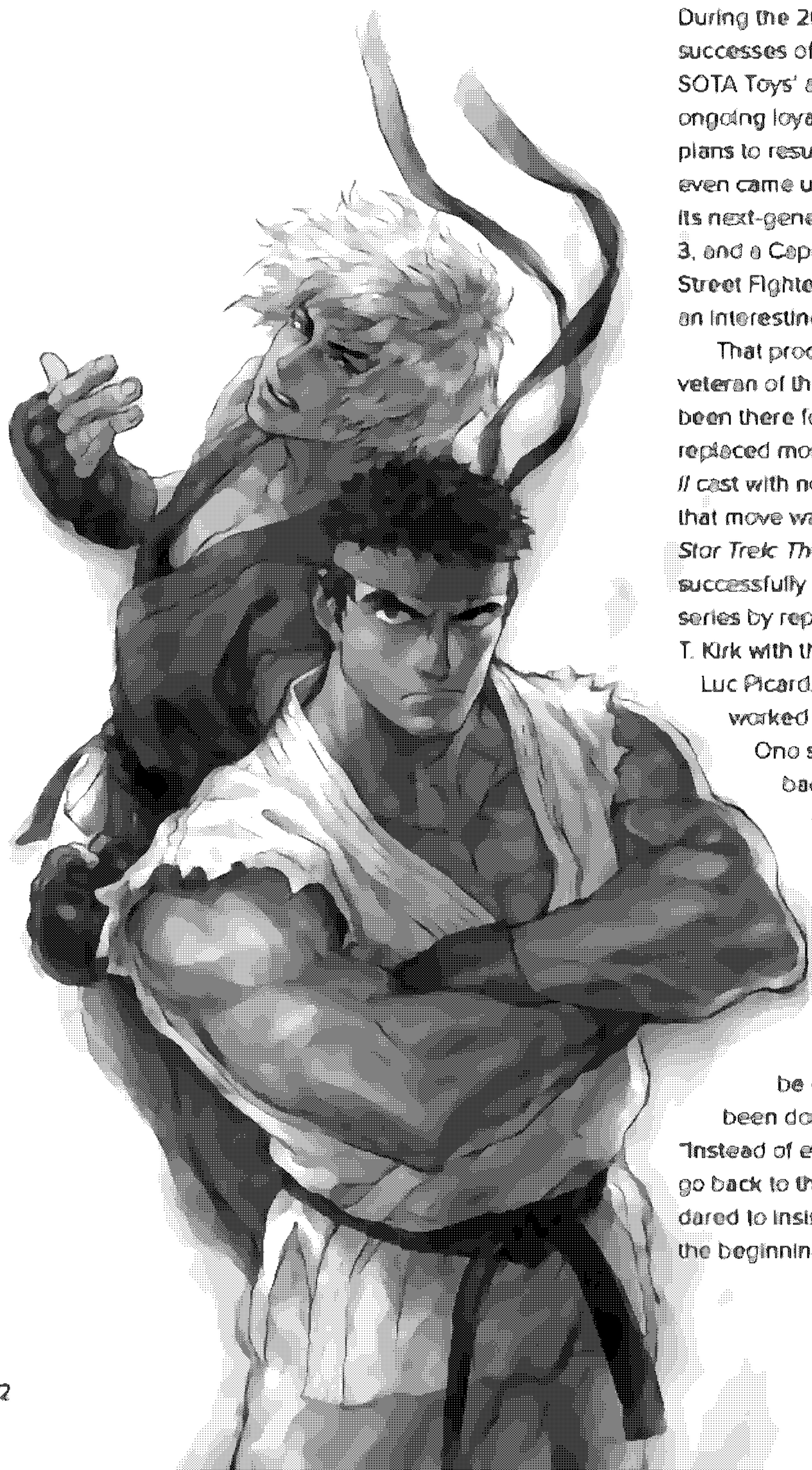
That producer, Yoshinori Ono, was a veteran of the Street Fighter team. He'd been there for *Street Fighter III*, a game that replaced most of the beloved *Street Fighter II* cast with new fighters. The theory behind that move was to replicate the formula of *Star Trek: The Next Generation*, which had successfully rebooted the famed sci-fi TV series by replacing the iconic Captain James T. Kirk with the equally iconic Captain Jean-Luc Picard. But the *Star Trek* formula hadn't worked for Street Fighter, and this time Ono suggested a game that brought back the old favorites. He wasn't envisioning a revolution, just a modest new title modeled after a high-school reunion that would allow longtime Street Fighter fans to get reacquainted with their old, animated friends.

"The feeling at Capcom was that everything that could be done in fighting games had been done. I didn't disagree," says Ono. "Instead of evolving or innovating, I wanted to go back to the '90s. 'Don't look to the future,' I dared to insist. Instead, it was, 'Let's go back to the beginning.'"

Ono got a green light to begin development. In doing so, he aimed hard at the nostalgia factor, not only populating the new game with fan-favorite characters from *Street Fighter II*, but even hiring some old Street Fighter hands to help develop the new game.

Fighting games were the calling card of a new Osaka game studio called Dimps. Its cofounders, Takashi Nishiyama and Hiroshi Matsumoto, had overseen SNK's run of 1990s fighting-game titles, in addition to creating the original 1987 *Street Fighter* game for Capcom. By hiring Dimps to assist in the new Street Fighter game's development, Ono was uniting the divided houses of Osaka's fighting-game community. The team began to devise its new game with an aesthetic and style that was faithful to the vision of *Street Fighter II* co-creators Akira Nishitani and Akira Yasuda (who had left Capcom during its fighting-game lull), but that also updated the characters and gameplay with all the graphical and technological advances that had occurred in Street Fighter's absence.

Ono and his team also made the smart decision to rely on feedback from expert players. They wanted to hire someone who could both advise the design team on the game and also build support among fighting-game players, a role similar to the one James Goddard had filled during *Street Fighter II*'s run. Capcom's U.S. office had a particular candidate in mind: Seth Killian, who had long since outgrown his days as an Internet troll at the University of Illinois, but who was still on campus at Urbana-Champaign, working as a philosophy professor. Killian had remained an active member of the Street Fighter community; Capcom's only challenge was convincing him to abandon a promising academic career for Ono's nostalgia project.





前页及上图:西村絹绘制的《街头霸王IV》插图;右图:森气楼绘制的《街头霸王IV》插图;下图:《街头霸王》系列制作人小野义徳。



基利安的回归

塞斯·基利安放弃了事业回来推动《街头霸王IV》

SETH KILLIAN KEPT PLAYING *Street Fighter* throughout graduate school. Even as he earned a PhD in philosophy at Illinois and began working toward a tenured faculty position, he competed in *Street Fighter* tournaments and helped the Cannon brothers pull off their annual EVO event. In 2006, after he orchestrated a Capcom-sponsored tournament at Comic-Con in San Diego, the company offered him a full-time job. It appealed to him from a sentimental perspective, but didn't make a ton of real-world sense.

"I'd been training to be an academic for ten years. I had a good gig, and the idea of walking away from it for an uncertain future in video games just didn't fit my risk profile," Killian recalls.

That's when Capcom let him in on its big secret: *Street Fighter IV* was in the works. He

heard the sales pitch about bringing back the magic of *Street Fighter II*. He saw the early wireframes, which looked cool, and he mulled the notion that he would have a chance to influence the game's development. He sighed. It was like getting a call from an old girlfriend, just as you had begun to feel like you'd moved on.

"I was so excited to hear about the new game, but at the same time it felt like a gut punch," Killian says. "Because it felt like, 'If I have this chance and don't take it, I'm going to think about this lost opportunity for the rest of my life.'"

Soon Killian was headed to California to begin his new, two-part job: pestering Capcom's Japanese development team about making changes to *Street Fighter IV*, and convincing his American friends that the game was going to be amazing.

“

假如我得到这个机会却没有接受,那我余生都会反复想起这个错过的机遇了。

——塞斯·基利安



右图:《街头霸王IV》
中各类角色的设计草
图;前页图:梅原大吾
和塞斯·基利安.





《街头霸王IV》的开发接近完成时,塞斯·基利安转而去处理这份新工作的第二个任务:该是召集《街头霸王》社群的时候了。

"我们来难为这些家伙(指游戏设计)吧。"

In order to truly believe the sales pitch he would be making to his disillusioned friends, Killian wanted to make sure the game really was great.

Sure, it looked promising. Toshiyuki Kamel, the art director, had developed a hand-painted aesthetic that enabled the game to show off high-tech, high-resolution, three-dimensional graphics while staying true to Street Fighter's distinctive style of hand-drawn animation. But Killian could anticipate his friends' gameplay critiques, and so he kept pushing for enhancements.

"I was never rude, but I got the sense that [Capcom's Japanese game-development group] considered the U.S. team to be just a local branch office, and they weren't used to getting tough feedback or a lot of demands from out in the sticks," says Killian. "The magnitude of things I was commenting on was outside of my place."

Fortunately for Killian, his boss—Mark Beaumont, leader of Capcom's U.S. office—stood behind him. "He kind of enjoyed it," recalls Killian. "He told me, 'Let's give these guys a hard time.'"

Killian's biggest influence was to put the brakes on one of Street Fighter's most significant planned updates: three-dimensional battlefields in which the characters could move sideways, not just forward and backward. "It gave the game a softer, spongier feel with just a little less 'crack' than the old Street Fighter games," says Killian. "It had that impostor feeling, like well-meaning aliens had watched a video of Street Fighter and tried to make their own. It was sympathetic, but not quite there."

Soon the 3-D movements were gone, and Street Fighter IV's signature look emerged, featuring three-dimensional characters fighting on a flat, two-dimensional plane.

Yoshinori Ono's team in Japan, meanwhile, had crafted a gameplay system that walked a fine line: first, it was familiar enough for old Street Fighter players to pick up and feel at home; second, it was intuitive and forgiving enough that newcomers wouldn't be too intimidated to learn the game; and finally, it was sufficiently sophisticated to accommodate the rigor of tournament play.

Ono was wary of Street Fighter newbies getting demolished by old pros, so one of his most important additions to the game was a

new type of attack called the Ultra Combo. Ultras were devastating attacks that became possible only after a player had weathered a storm of assaults; it essentially gave lesser players a puncher's chance in order to keep them from growing frustrated and walking away.

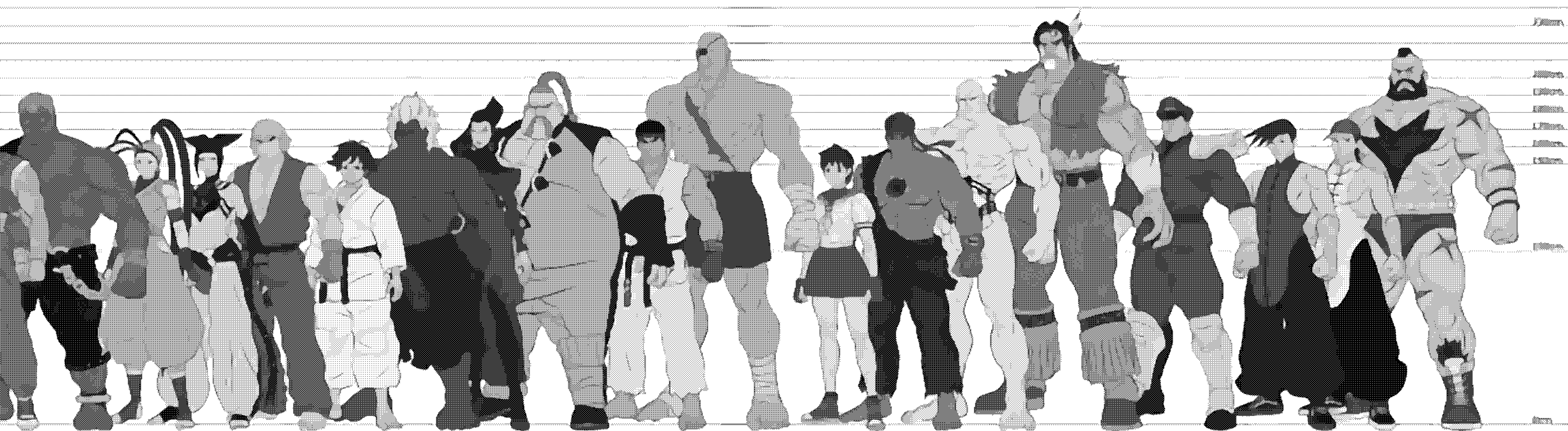
"We wanted to renew the fighting spirits of casual players, and for them to think that if they continue playing, they might win next time," says Ono.

大推销

As the game neared the end of its development, Seth Killian turned to the second aspect of his new job: It was time to rally the Street Fighter community.

"People were resistant, because I was trying to pull them out of their successful adult lives. But I was telling them all, 'Hey man, we're getting the band back together!' I kept trying to strike that emotional chord: that this game was real, it wasn't an impostor Street Fighter, and we were going to bring it all back."

Street Fighter IV hit Japanese arcades in July 2008 and a short time later arrived in the U.S.—just in time for demonstration matches at



“

这个系列的回归就看这一仗了。

——塞斯·基利安

EVO, the August fighting-games tournament in Las Vegas.

This was the tournament that Justin Wong almost skipped. The greatest American Street Fighter player of the 2000s was ready to walk away, which would have further decimated the Street Fighter community. Wong agreed to fly to Nevada and compete only after Killian talked him into it. Killian was pulling out all the stops in order to get the new game noticed.

"I was telling myself, 'You had this whole life laid out in front of you with friends and family back in Illinois, and you abandoned all of it to go chase Street Fighter. So don't blow it,'" Killian recalls. "It also felt like this was the one shot to bring the series back. If this didn't work, the franchise would be dead, and more importantly, the feeling would be dead."

Wong showed up and placed in the top ten of all four EVO tournaments that featured Street Fighter characters, winning one of them. He also got to try *Street Fighter IV*. It still was not a given that the new Street Fighter title was going to take off, but Killian had held the community together long enough to give the series' comeback bid a fighting chance.

右图:贾斯汀·王差点缺席了2008年EVO(世界格斗游戏大会);下图:EVO上无数人观看着里基·奥尔蒂斯(Ricki Ortiz)与梅原大吾的比赛。



完美推出

《街头霸王IV》的娴熟的发布手段吸引了粉丝们的注意

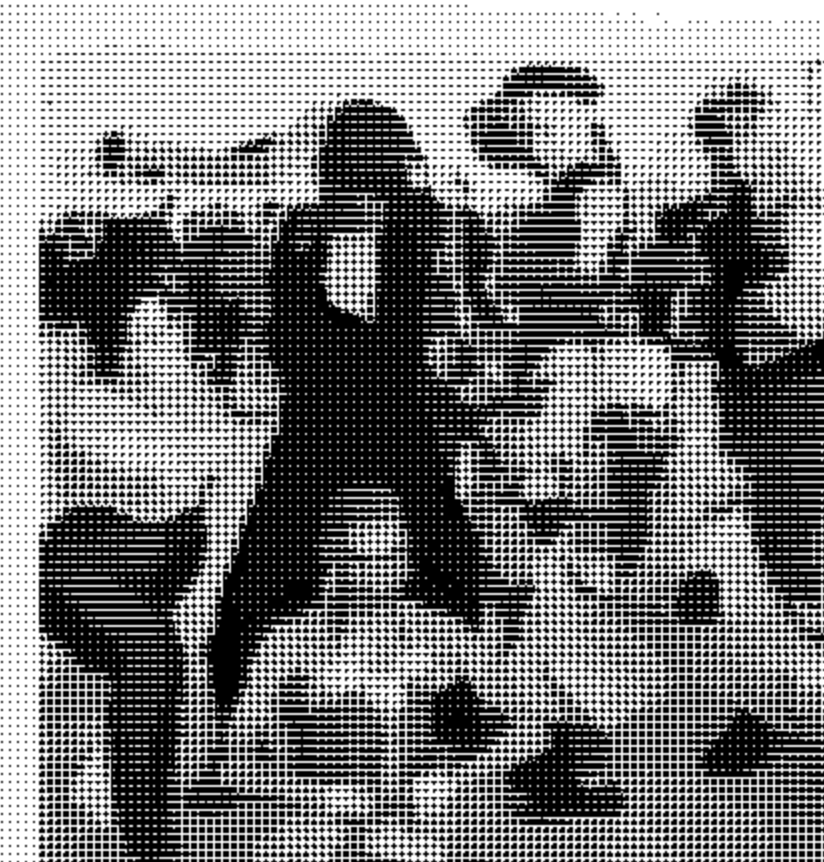
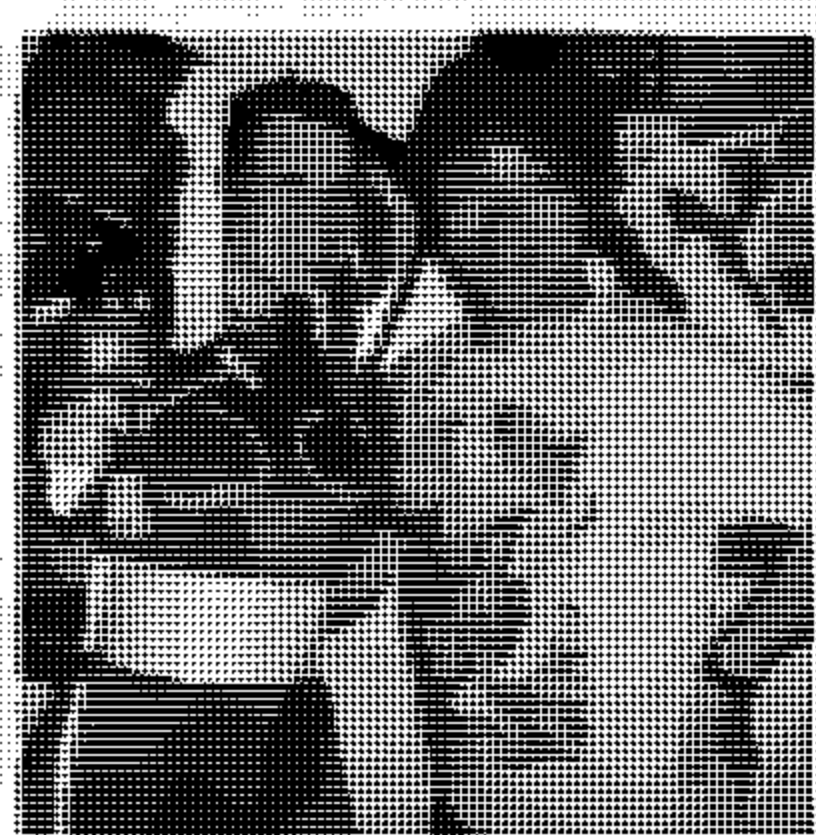
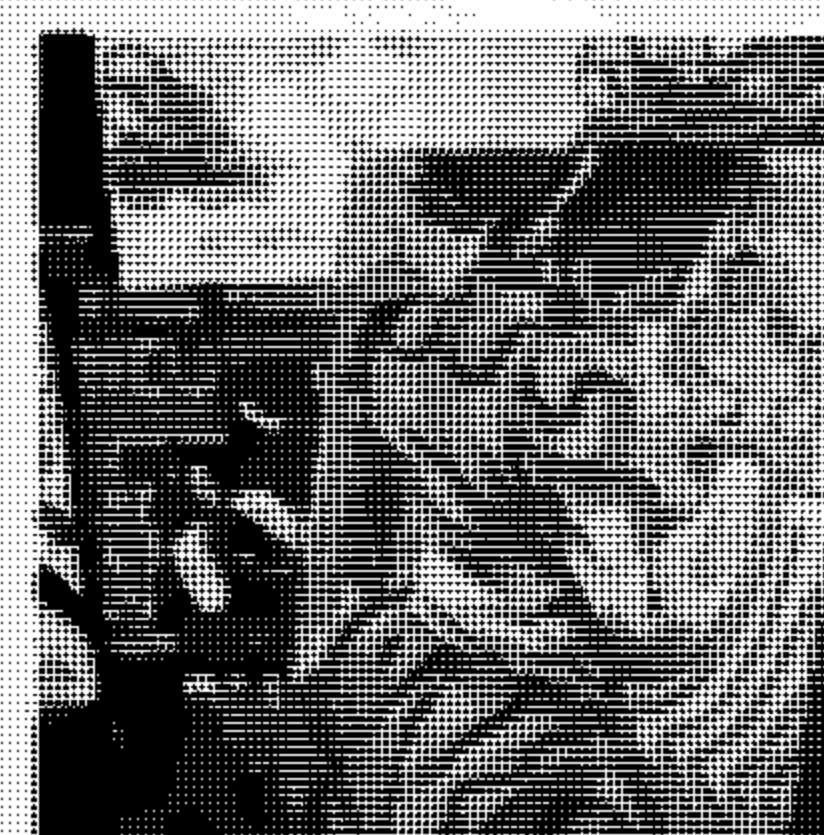
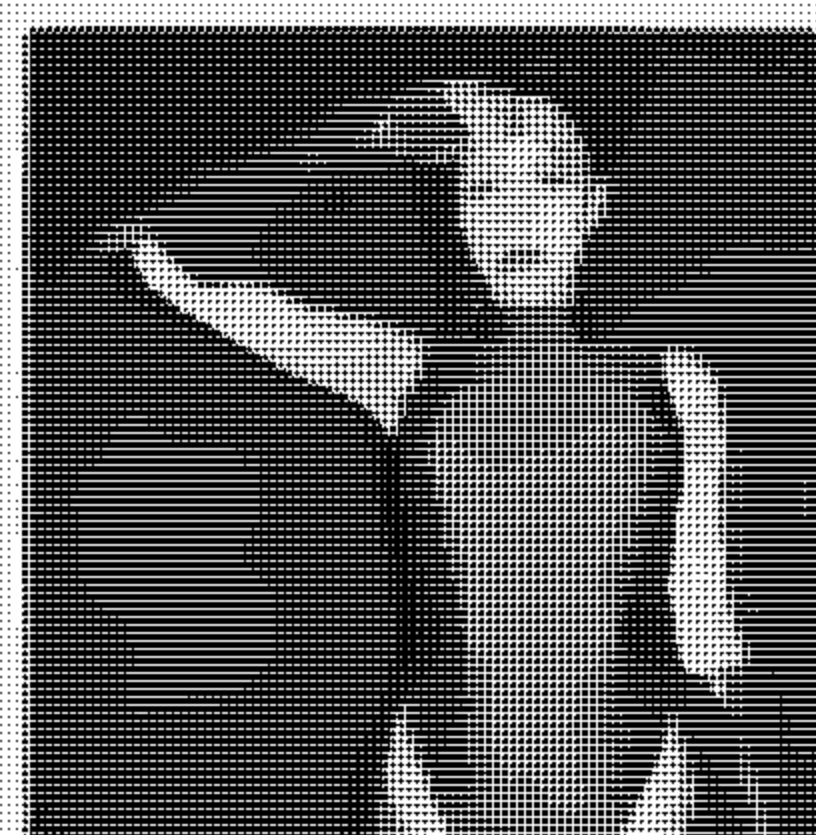
ON A PERFECT SUMMER evening in 2008, hundreds of people waited in a line that wrapped around the block in a shadowy Los Angeles industrial district. Their ultimate destination was a dark warehouse filled with the latest, hottest imported merchandise: *Street Fighter IV* arcade machines from Japan, enclosed in a giant chain-link cage. This was Street Fighter Club, a promotional event that eschewed red carpets and VIPs in favor of the gritty allure of an underground fight scene. Challengers who had heard about the event through cryptic message-board posts or word of mouth made their way forward, preparing to try their hand at the long-awaited new Street Fighter game.

Once inside, the fans were treated to live music, drinks and prizes—and most importantly, a first look at *Street Fighter IV*. As the fans took turns getting a taste of competition, it became clear that the game was connecting with its target audience.

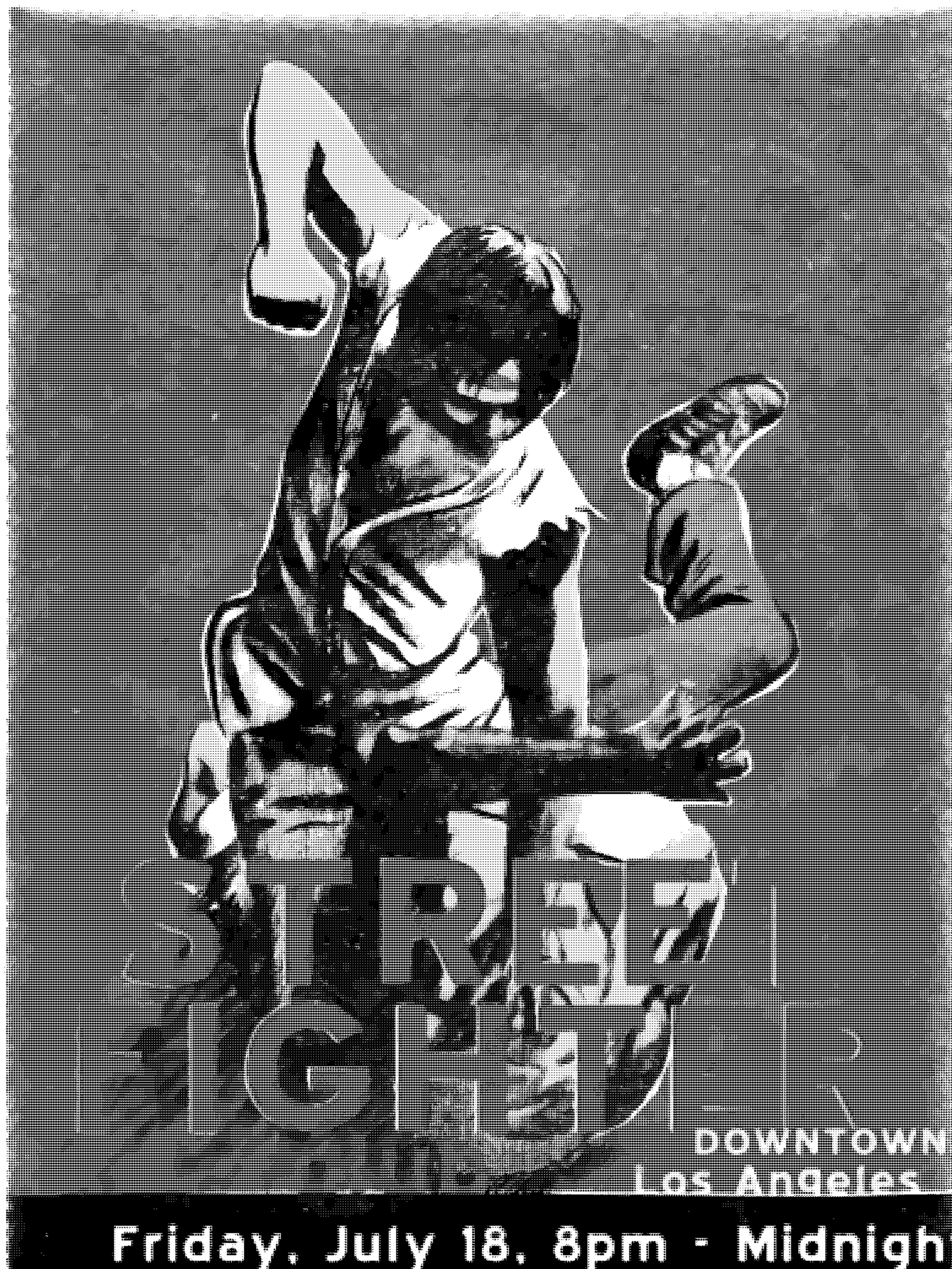
"We were awakening a sleeping giant," says Jon M. Gibson, founder of iam8bit, the Los Angeles production company that created the event for Capcom. Gibson and his business partner, Amanda White, modeled the event after the illegal, underground dub-step parties they had attended years before. They'd gotten permits for Street Fighter Club, but otherwise were trying to capture the same vibe.

"Street Fighter has never been about celebrity or fame or opulence," says Gibson. "It's about sweat and barrels and beating up cars."

The event was a hit, as was a followup in Brooklyn, New York. People were talking about Street Fighter again.



卡普空炮制的“街头霸王俱乐部”活动及iam8bit展会成功推动了《街头霸王IV》的势头。



我们唤醒了一个沉睡的巨人。

—乔恩·吉布森, iam8bit创始人



《街头霸王IV》引发的狂热反响令小野义徳(左)和塞斯·基利安(上二)兴奋不已。





高清重制带来的推动力

STREET FIGHTER IV WASN'T the only new Street Fighter game on display at the Street Fighter Club events. Its companion was *Super Street Fighter II Turbo HD Remix*, an update of the Street Fighter series' flagship title that included redrawn, high-definition graphics as well as balance changes. Capcom outsourced development to a North American duo that included two Street Fighter superfans: artist Long Vo, a member of the Udon collective that produced Street Fighter comics, and Backbone Entertainment game designer David Sirlin, who was a longtime competitive player.

There wasn't a huge budget for the project, but Vo and Sirlin hurtled themselves at it with abandon. Sirlin snuck in after hours to work on the project even after the project budget was exhausted. Vo both created the updated visual style and also managed a complex, multinational project in which multiple Asian firms translated his key art into smooth, vivid animated characters and moves. The game earned back the entirety of its development budget on the day of its release in late 2008, the latest sign that Street Fighter's revival was real.

Capcom's Street Fighter producer, Yoshinori Ono, had been uncertain about the commercial appeal of his nostalgia project. But the buzz was building, and the sales of *HD Remix* were encouraging, as were the pre-sales of *Street Fighter IV* console games. Suddenly, he was surrounded by believers.

"Until we saw the preorders, everyone here was wondering whether we could still sell this kind of game in the 21st century," says Ono. "Then we started getting all these preorders. Everyone changed sides, saying, 'Ono, I knew you were going to sell them!'"

画师VO重新绘制了《超级街霸II:极速版》的像素图,制作2008年的《超级街霸II:极速版》高清重制版。

旧版



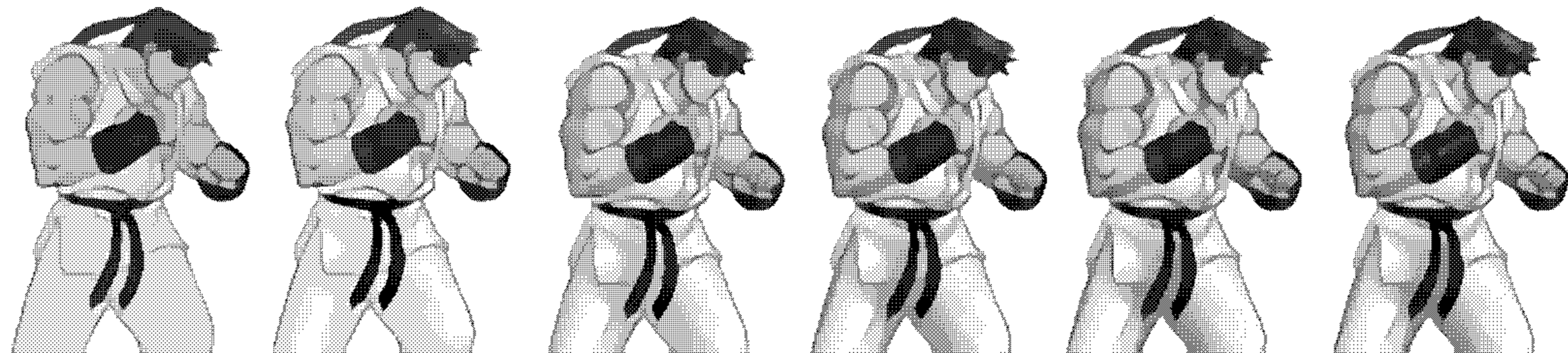
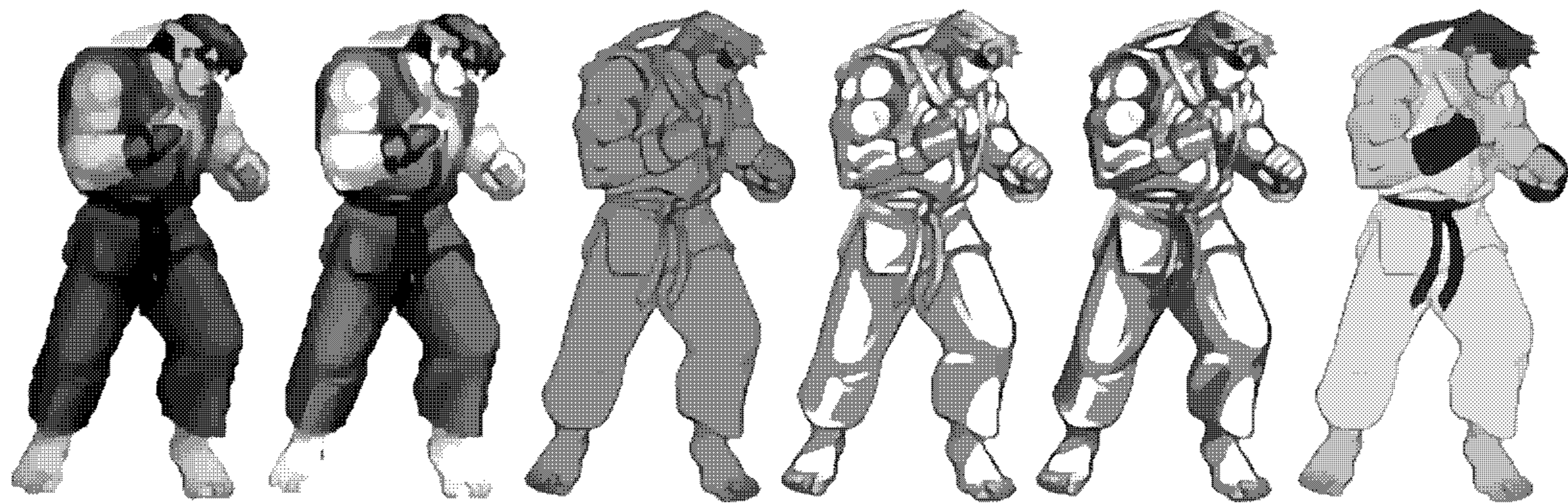
新版



草图



草图





人群涌入EVO(上)观看顶级玩家们展现“魔法”。他们有梅原大吾(中),Nuckle Du(右图左,已退役),棒豪(右图右,家暴凉了)等;下图左至右:观众们的反应;塞斯·基利安祝贺梅原大吾;贾斯汀·王捧杯。



锦标赛场的重生

THE FINAL COMPONENT OF *Street Fighter IV*'s rollout was a nationwide tournament held at all 2,400 U.S. locations of retailer GameStop, starting in February 2009, just three days after the game's release. The prize was a *Street Fighter IV* arcade cabinet, and the massive tournament not only attracted newcomers to the series, but also provided a mass audience for the *Street Fighter* stars who had dominated competition during the previous decade. New Yorker Justin Wong wasn't aiming for glory when he decided to compete—"I had just always wanted an arcade cabinet," he says.

Two months later, at the GameStop

tournament finals, more than a thousand spectators watched Wong win the U.S. competition and claim his *Street Fighter IV* machine. Wong then faced and defeated the winners of two international tournaments before competing in a world-title match against Japan's legendary Daigo Umehara, whom Killian had invited just for a little extra sizzle. Killian could tell from the crowd's reaction that a new generation was learning to appreciate high-level *Street Fighter* play, and that his career gambit had been a success. When the crowd went wild as Umehara defeated Wong, Killian finally relaxed. After years of stress, he could say for

certain that *Street Fighter* was back.

The momentum continued at EVO later that summer, where the *Street Fighter IV* tournament drew more than a thousand competitors and resulted in another Umehara victory over Wong in the finals. Wong hated losing, but the silver lining was the energy in the building. "That was the moment I knew it was coming back. There was such a crazy big increase in attendance, and the atmosphere was amazing," he recalls.

A year after almost skipping EVO, Wong was all in. "From there, I just wanted to keep going," he says.



很快,巴列就在朋友的车库里合作主办了一项《街头霸王》每周培训活动,叫做《周三格斗夜》。

艾利克斯·巴列,约翰·崔和塞斯·基利安在庆祝《街头霸王》的重生。

乐团携手归来

《街头霸王IV》的流行带回了老朋友们

IN THE MONTHS FOLLOWING *Street Fighter IV*'s release in early 2009, new and casual players flocked to the game, and Capcom celebrated its biggest *Street Fighter* hit since the halcyon days of *Street Fighter II*. But the old guard wasn't uniformly thrilled with the new *Street Fighter* game. They were purists, and the changes Yoshinori Ono had added to make the game easier to play and more friendly to newcomers were hard to swallow.

"Everyone started playing again because *Street Fighter IV* was easy to play," says John Choi, the longtime king of Northern California's *Street Fighter* scene. "The barriers to execution were lower, and the concepts were more digestible. It felt a little like things were being dumbed down, and a lot of people didn't like it—me included."

Yet it was also hard for Choi to stay on the sidelines as *Street Fighter*'s popularity exploded. This was *his* game, after all, not the property of novice newcomers. Soon he jumped in.

"I decided that at the end of day, I would rather play a simpler game that has a scene with thousands of players," he says.

British champion Ryan Hart felt similarly. He preferred *Street Fighter III: 3rd Strike*, but acknowledged that "*Street Fighter IV* is where the community was building. I wanted to be competitive, and that meant going where the competition was."

Seth Killian's dream of getting the band back together was working; even the reluctant members were getting sucked back into *Street Fighter*'s orbit.

周三格斗夜

Alex Valle didn't need any convincing. Like Choi, he had taken a step back from competitive play while he worked a series of jobs that ranged from Coca-Cola sales manager to quality-assurance tester for a Korean gaming company. But he never lost his passion for *Street Fighter*, and when *Street*

Fighter IV was released, he was ready to jump back in—except that he was utterly disgusted by the skill level of this new crop of Southern California players.

"It was cool that there was this huge reboot of the scene, but all these new players sucked," says Valle. "I went to arcades and would get angry because of what had happened to the Southern California scene. These new players were just flailing around and needed some guidance."

That was the beginning of a new chapter for Valle, one in which he served as mentor and coach, as well as star player.

"Until then, Valle was only concerned with taking tournaments, not building community," says James Chen, a fellow longtime California player. "But he had been the man in SoCal for so long, and watching SoCal get bodied was like watching his legacy die."

Soon Valle was co-hosting a weekly *Street Fighter* training event called Wednesday Night

其中一位常客开始直播这一活动,建立了庞大的观众群,证明(格斗游戏)比赛解说与评论是可取的。

Fights out of a friend's garage. They set up as many console gaming systems as they could muster, then watched as the weekly gathering grew from a handful of people to two dozen, and then 50. Valle was the crusty drill sergeant who not only harped on his young pupils to practice, but even threatened to kick some of them out if they didn't improve.

"I called them 'banned' matches, and it was a tough-love thing," he says. "It was a bunch of millennials saying 'I don't get it, I can't do it,' and I had to think of a way to get more out of them. Like, do you want to be a good player or a top player—what's your deal? I wanted them to feel more urgency. So with the banned matches, the rule was that if you bottomed out you couldn't come back. I didn't tell them that I'd invite them back after a month anyway."

The level of competition quickly improved, and soon the top matchups at Wednesday Night Fights featured elite competition. One of the regular attendees started live-streaming the events, building a large enough audience to justify play-by-play commentary. That's when Valle turned to James Chen and told him to grab a microphone. Chen complied.

"I wanted to see how hard [play-by-play] was, and sure enough, it was hard. But I started doing it, and got more addicted to that than to playing," Chen says. He experimented with different styles—the sardonic jokester, the excitable hype man—before "deciding consciously to go down a path of being knowledgeable and educational, and talking about why certain characters do what they do. I try to put myself in the shoes of people who have no idea what's going on."

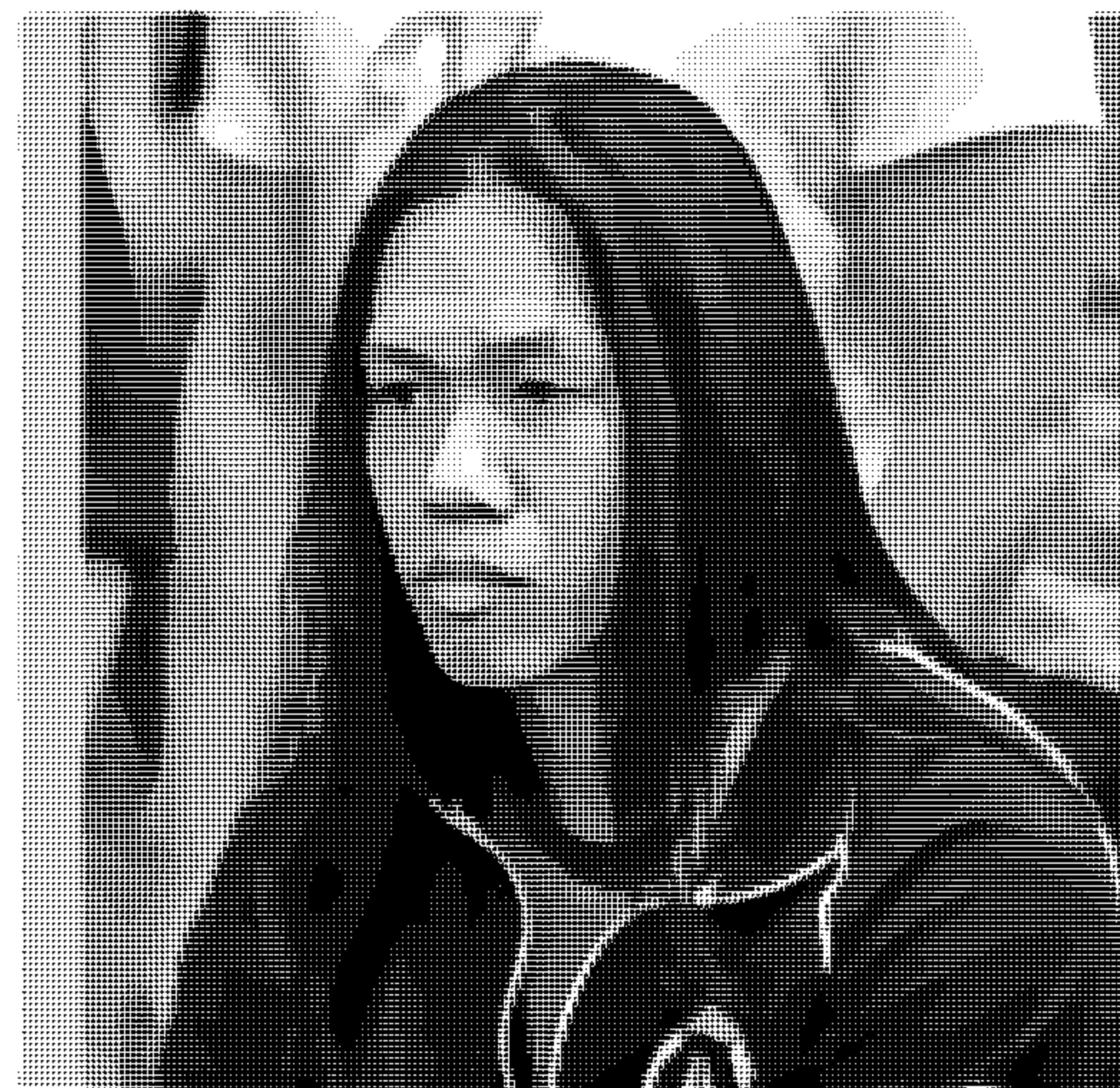
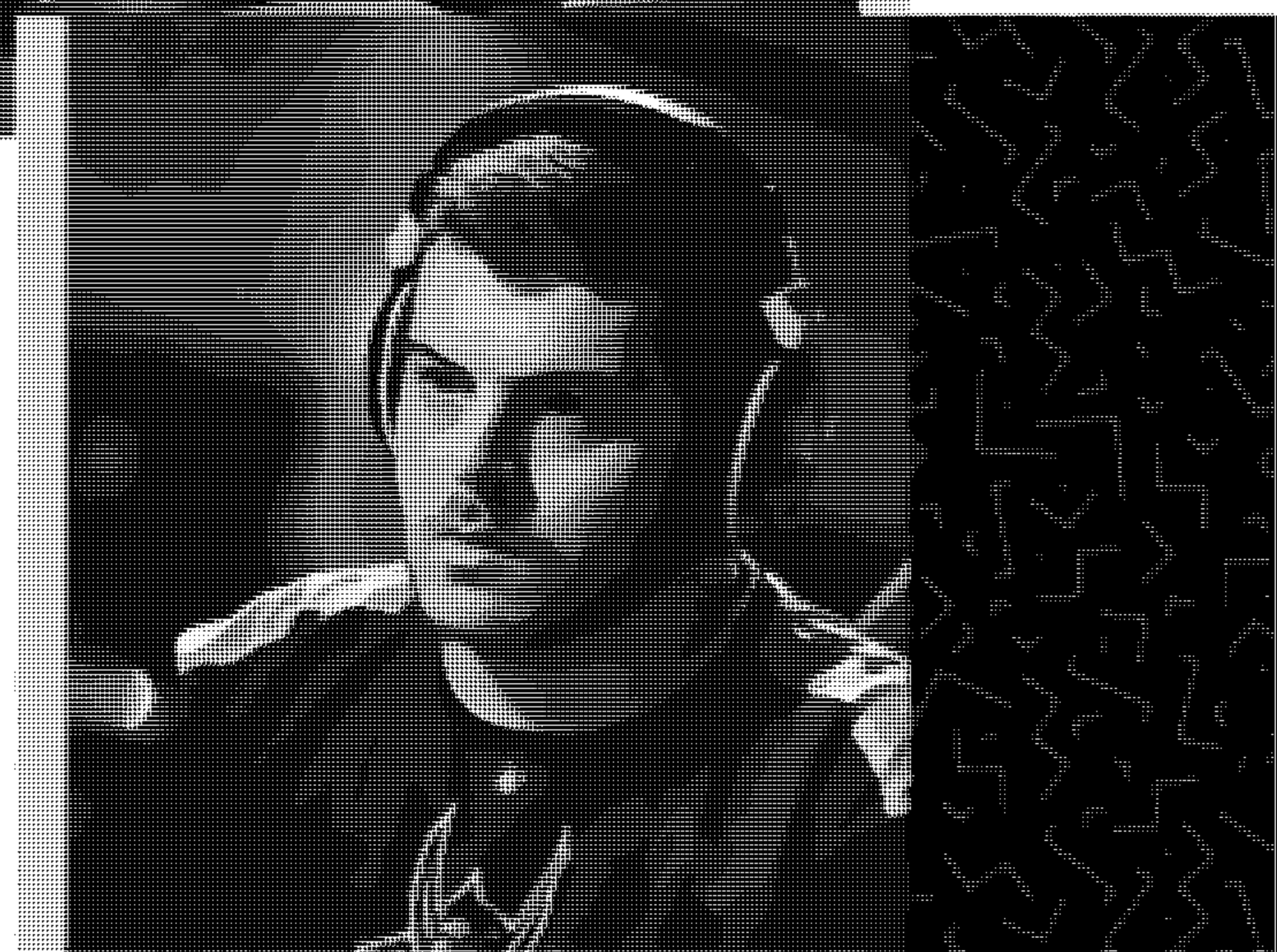
Wednesday Night Fights became a hotbed of Street Fighter talent, producing top young players such as Alex Myers and Frankie Lee, Jr., and even cultivating a signature fighting style—albeit one that is conspicuously different from Valle's own frenetic, aggressive approach.



《周三格斗夜》中出场的詹姆斯·陈(上),艾利克斯·巴列(右)和小弗兰基·李(下)。

"Those Wednesday Night Fights players are technicians," says Ryan Hart, the British champion. "They like to pick their spots and they're very observant, looking for certain situations that they want to exploit."

So Valle succeeded both in revitalizing the Southern California Street Fighter scene and raising its level of play. What's more, 15 years after he first devoted himself to Street Fighter, he finally turned his network of SoCal fighting-gamers into a marketable group of gaming professionals. Chen now handles play-by-play for top fighting-game tournaments around the country, and co-owns a streaming-video portal for fighting-game fans called UltraChenTV. Ryan Gutierrez started a training platform called Cross Counter TV. Valle himself is CEO of a live-streaming company called Level-Up Productions. Wednesday Night Fights, which started as an incubator for Street Fighter talent, became an incubator of startup companies as well.



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——戴夫·朗,"钢铁星系"工作室创办者

下图:"钢铁星系"工作室创办者戴夫·朗;右图:斯坦利·劳为《街头霸王III:第3次冲击》在线版绘制的插图。



向多人游戏发展

《街头霸王III:第3次冲击》在网络中焕发新生

THE FRUITS OF *Street Fighter IV*'s success weren't limited to the Wednesday Night Fights crew. Justin Wong, the championship player who had come of age in New York City's Chinatown Fair arcade in the 1990s, moved to Northern California and became a bona fide professional player. Daigo Umehara, Wong's Japanese arch-nemesis, did the same, signing a sponsorship deal with arcade-stick manufacturer Mad Catz. And the biggest winner of all was Capcom, which responded to the breakout popularity of its new game by reverting to its 1990s formula: cranking out a dizzying array of fighting games.

For starters, there were three different iterations of *Street Fighter IV* released between 2009 and 2011. *Street Fighter*'s characters were also packed into a slew of crossover games, with Capcom releasing three different *Marvel vs. Capcom* titles in 2011 and 2012, as well as *Street Fighter vs.*

Tekken, the first installment in a new crossover series. Finally, in a nod to the cult-hit status and unfulfilled commercial potential of *Street Fighter III: 3rd Strike*, Capcom released an updated version of that game in 2011 that was designed to facilitate online play.

To create the updated version of *3rd Strike*, Capcom turned to a newly formed Chicago game studio called Iron Galaxy. Dave Lang, the studio's founder, was grateful for the rare opportunity to update a game that was beloved by many, yet was no one's definition of a hit.

"On one level, the project doesn't make sense and really shouldn't exist: 'Let's take this business failure and do a lovingly crafted, bespoke port of it,'" Lang says. "But it does exist, and it's a nice reward for those hardcore fans."

Lang's team knew exactly what it meant to be hardcore fighting-game fans. Iron Galaxy's

team included many veterans of Midway Games—a company that had produced one of *Street Fighter*'s rival series in the 1990s, *Mortal Kombat*, but that had ceased operations in 2010. Iron Galaxy's group of fighting gamers attacked the new fighting-game project with zeal.

When *3rd Strike Online Edition* was released in August 2011, the game featured a set of specs that appealed to hardcore players. Iron Galaxy's work was like a belated, melancholy-tinged gift to lovers of *Street Fighter III* who had moved on to *Street Fighter IV* because of its popularity, but still considered *3rd Strike* the apex of the series.

As for Lang, the allure of *3rd Strike* stuck with him; in 2013, he collaborated with game-designer Adam Keits Heart on a fighting-game parody called *Divekick*, whose twin protagonists are a tribute to *3rd Strike* characters Yun and Yang.

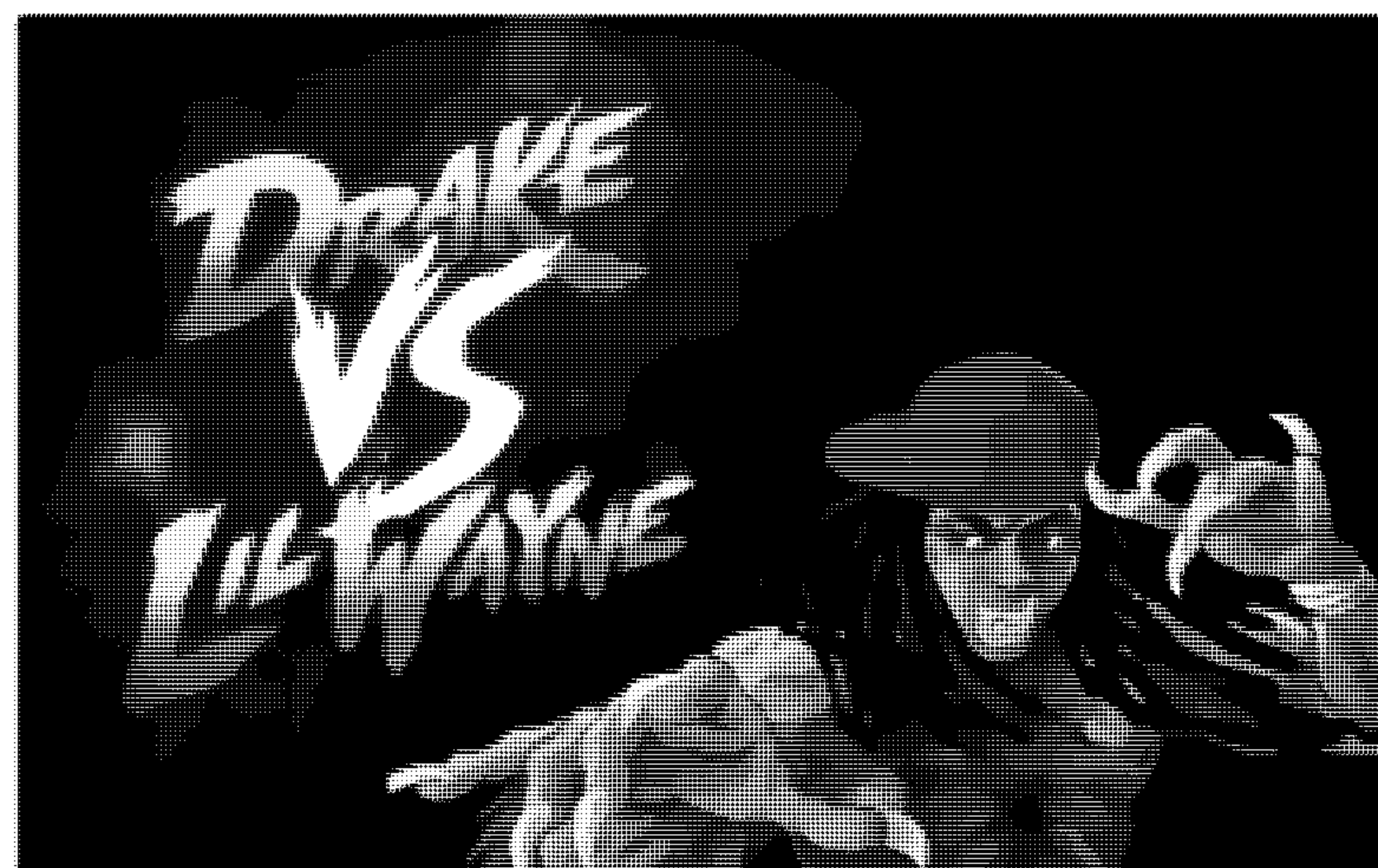


076,821,400,515



连招

爱德·江(上),克里斯·默里(中)和戴夫·克罗斯兰(下)为lam8bit的2012年洛杉矶街头霸王主题展“连招”创作的作品。



lam8bit为2014年“德拉克对小韦恩(或者干脆叫小布兰卡?)”巡回赛开发的应用软件背景图。

H嘻哈文化的广泛认可AL

ULTRA STREET FIGHTER IV arrived in 2014 as the final iteration of the hit game. Its status as a pop-culture phenomenon was cemented when superstar rappers Drake and Lil Wayne used a Street Fighter theme on their summer tour, turning to Los Angeles' lam8bit to create a mobile-phone app that depicted the rappers as world warriors.

There was more evidence of the series' resurgence, too. Attendance at EVO continued to climb, with its 2015 Ultra Street Fighter IV tournament drawing more than 2,000 competitors. Capcom even launched its own competitive series in 2013, the Capcom Pro Tour and Capcom Cup. And in early 2016, another celebrity rapper, Kanye West, sampled Street Fighter II audio prominently on his record The Life of Pablo.

West's record was released just two days before an ever more crucial moment in the life of Street Fighter. On February 16, 2016, the company released Street Fighter V.



《街头霸王》的后续行动

《街头霸王V》是卡普空重启成功后大干一番的好机会

IT SEEMS TO BE the natural progression of fighting games to gradually increase the number of playable characters: 1991's *Street Fighter II* had eight, while 1994's *Super Street Fighter II Turbo* boasted 16; *Street Fighter Alpha* had ten, while the final portable console versions of *Alpha 3* had 38. So when *Ultra Street Fighter IV*'s roster ballooned to 42 playable characters, it wasn't shocking—but it was unwieldy, all the same.

"Any time you add even one new character, it makes the game exponentially more complex," says *Street Fighter* champion John Choi.

It made sense, then, that when Capcom's Takayuki Nakayama was handed the reins to *Street Fighter V*, the first word on his mind was "reset." He pared the character roster back to a launch-day list of 16: eight well-known *Street Fighter II* favorites along with four new characters and four less-prominent series holdovers. And he decided to invest heavily in each of them.

One of the defining features of the *Street Fighter* series since *Street Fighter II* had been

that each collection of games had its own, unique system mechanic: the custom combos in the *Alpha* series, the parry system in *Street Fighter III*, and the "Ultra" system that enabled dramatic comebacks in *Street Fighter IV*.

Without mastering those systems, "basically you couldn't participate in the game," says Nakayama. "You would definitely lose. And it was a general system, so all characters had to use it."

Nakayama didn't like the extent to which mastery of these overarching systems was superseding mastery of the individual characters. So in *Street Fighter V*, he set out to change that—and to move the series in the direction of its flagship title, *Street Fighter II*.

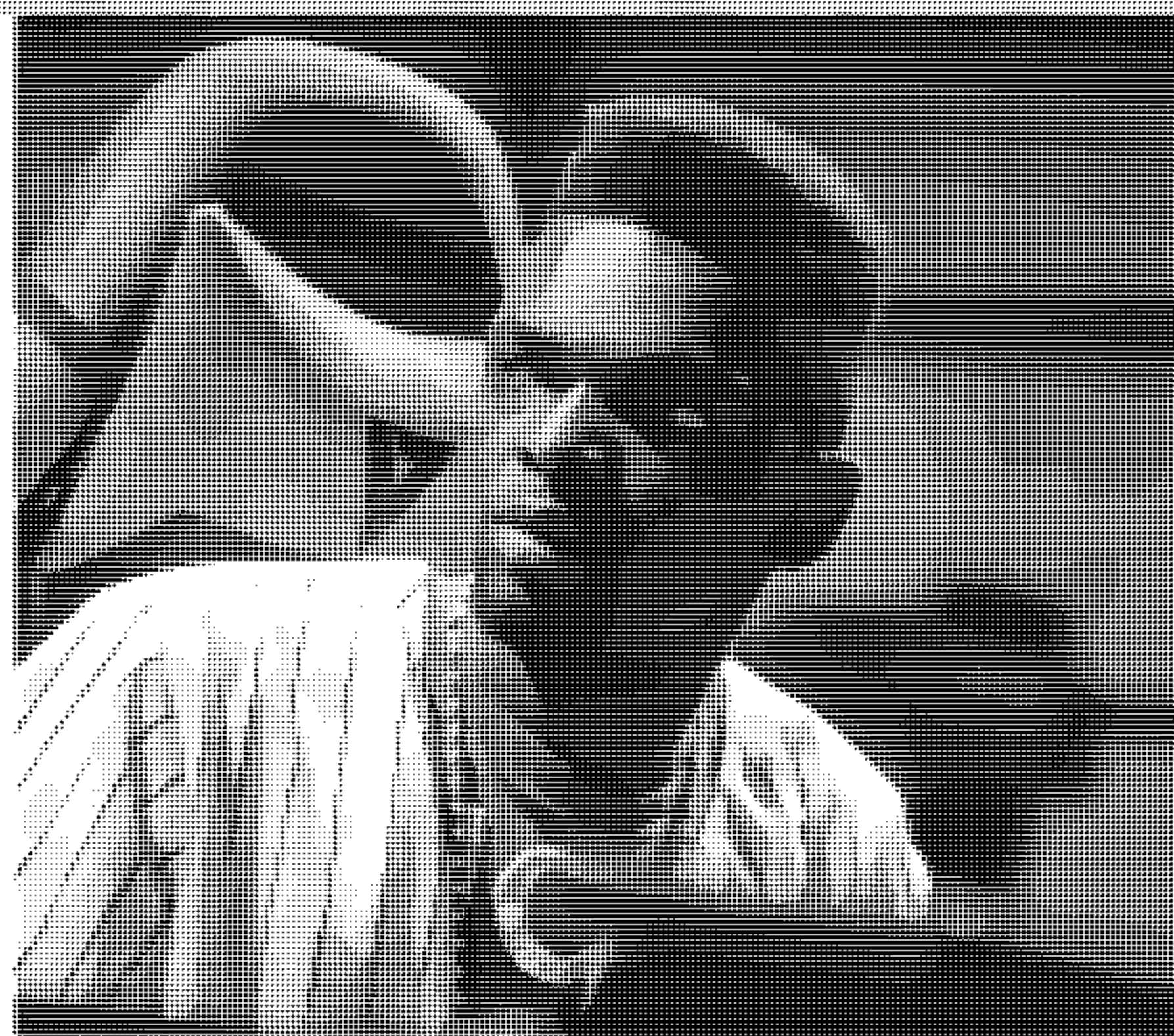
"We wanted the system to be subordinate to the characters, not the other way around," says Nakayama. "We wanted different systems for each character."

As a result, Nakayama's game features exceptional individuality among its cast. Some game-wide mechanics remain, but they are highly customized for each character. The result is a game in which the personalities of

the individual fighters shine. Nakayama also seeded the game with references to *Street Fighter*'s past—not the casual fan's nostalgia trip from *Street Fighter IV*, but serious, inside stuff. For example, after Nakayama heard about how *Street Fighter III* chief Tomoshi Sadamoto had dreamed of a parried Hadoken skittering into the background and impacting the surrounding area, he decided *Street Fighter V* should feature a surplus of interaction between characters and their environment.

Those interactions are often playful, such as when a Russian nesting doll lands on the head of a defeated fighter. That, too, is part of *Street Fighter*'s legacy.

"Nakayama told us that making ridiculous things with all our strength is one of the things that characterizes *Street Fighter*, so we created these effects," says Tomoaki Ayano, a *Street Fighter* producer. "We do the silly things seriously. If a character gets a bowl of ramen dumped on his head after losing—well, those things take a lot of time to create, but we do it with a lot of energy and effort."



2016年的EVO《街头霸王V》锦标赛上,创纪录的5000人同场竞技。



左上:“Smug”正在评估对手;
右上:小野义徳祝贺Nuckle Du
获得2016年卡普空杯的胜利;
上图:《街头霸王V》中,隆精
准把握时机,防住了肯的龙卷
旋风脚攻击。

《街头霸王》永不结束的旅程

Street Fighter V's 2016 release didn't follow any sort of familiar script; its launch was neither a *Street Fighter III*-style dud nor a *Street Fighter IV*-like triumph. A record 5,000 people competed in EVO's 2016 *Street Fighter V* tournament, which was televised on ESPN2. The game was also featured on the 2017 e-sports television show E-League, and reviewers praised the core gameplay. On the other hand, players bristled at server outages and a dearth of ancillary content available shortly after the game's launch. But where *Street Fighter V* truly differs from its predecessors is that it can improve over time. In the 1990s, *Street Fighter* updates were packaged as new games, and often rushed to market—sometimes to capitalize on the success of a prior release, and other times to atone for an earlier game's shortcomings. With *Street Fighter V*, Capcom plans to update and improve its game incrementally over time, cultivating what it hopes is a growing legion of players who will compete online.

It's a mission worthy of the series' determined hero, Ryu, who wanders the earth in search of self-improvement. And it's fitting for a series that has proven resilient and innovative over the course of its 30-year run.

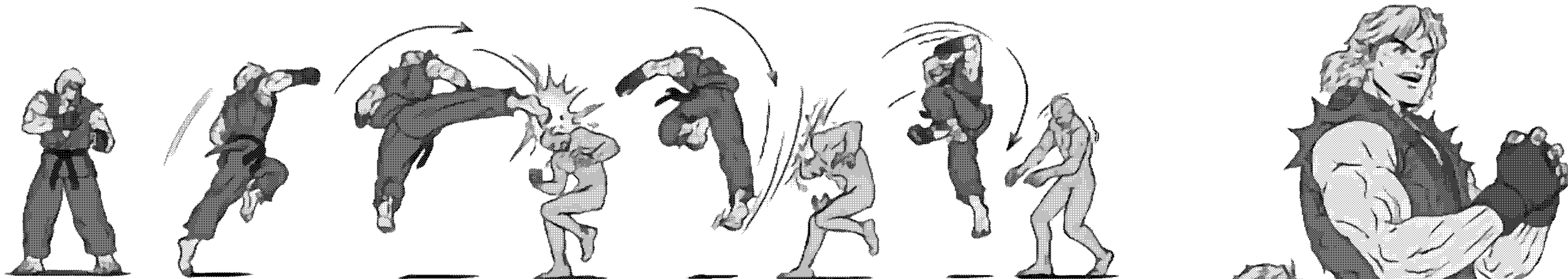


我们对《街头霸王V》的设想是让每个角色都能展现出他们30年来最好的特点。

——小野义德，《街头霸王》系列制作人



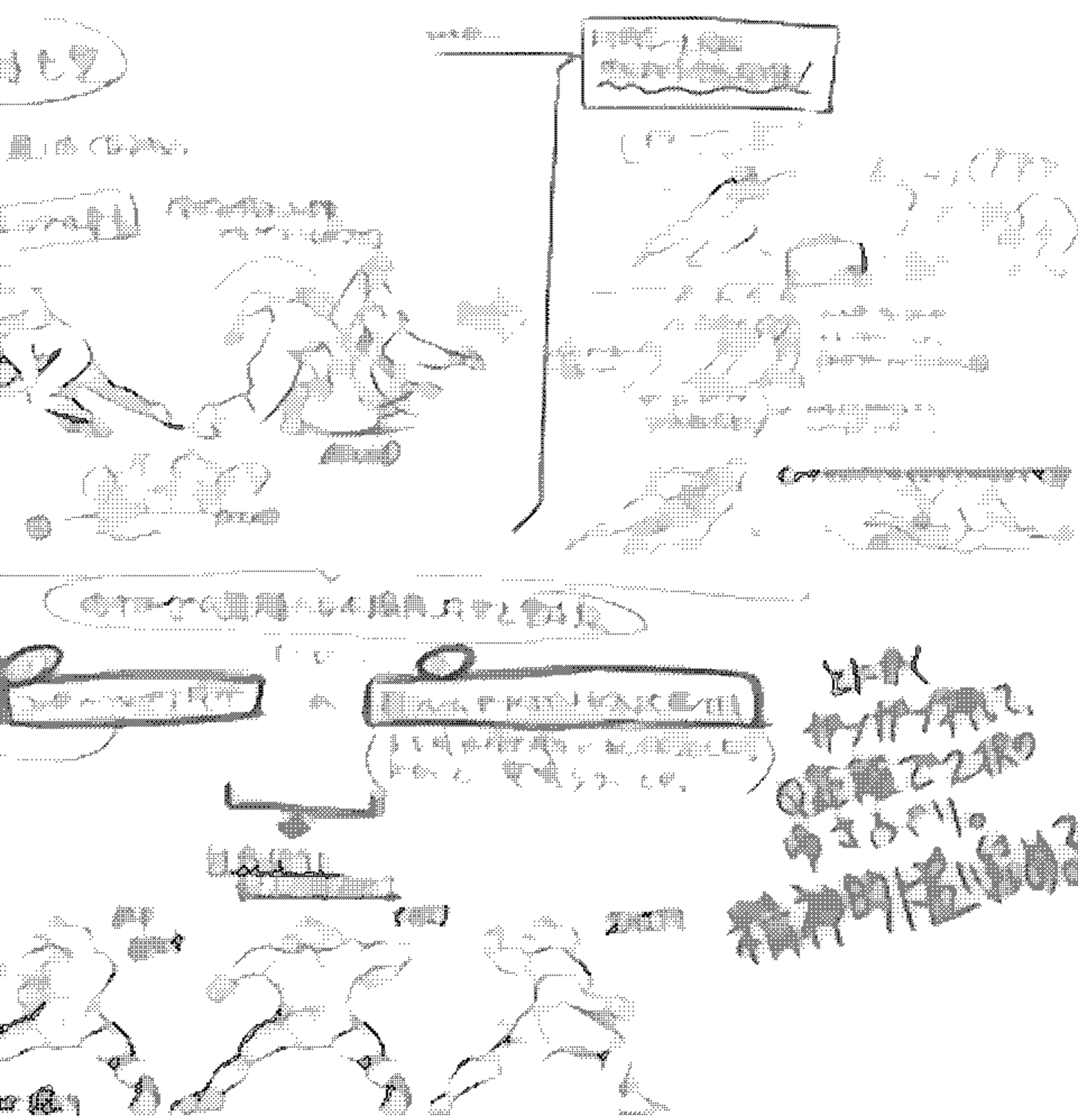
THE BIG COMEBACK



Steep Kick (with fire effect - Prep look, show, stepped)



Steep Kick (with fire effect - Prep look, show, stepped)



Kiwai Tetsu no Tama

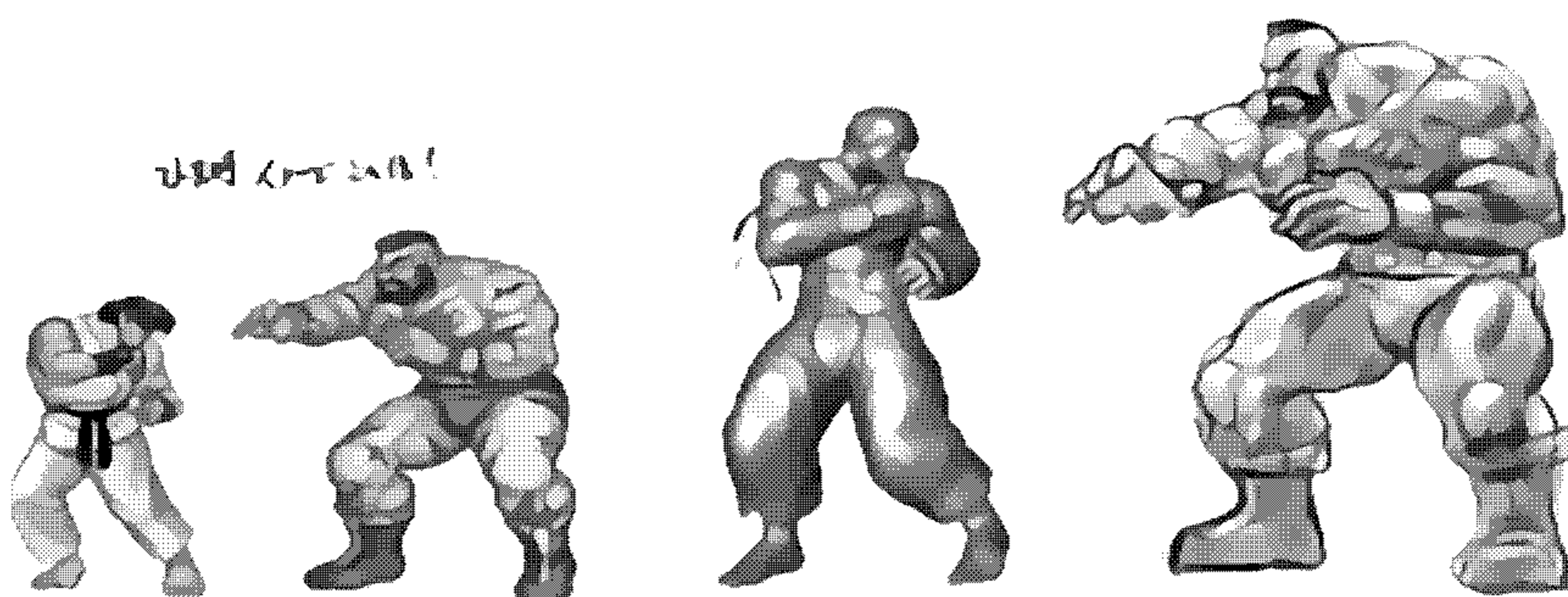
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上图:《街头霸王V》开发中的草案;下页图:
"Bengus"为2017年SWITCH游戏《终极街头霸王II:最后的挑战者》绘制的插图,呼应了他1993年的《超级街头霸王II》全角色图(参见上一册P7)。



THE BIG COMEBACK



ACTION FIGURES

好人,坏人和可动人

90年代《街头霸王》的全球声望到达顶点之时,也是可动人偶(虚构的英雄们可供把玩的微缩版本)黄金时代的落幕.但在跨国生产商对可动人偶业务望而却步后,那些小公司进来填补了空白,创作出了比前者关节更细致,更具实感的新人物.

The action-figure versions of Street Fighter's characters have run the gamut: they've been absorbed into the iconic G.I. Joe franchise, pitted against mutant warriors, and honored with several different lines of innovative, beautiful, painstakingly crafted figures. Let's look back at four prominent series of Street Fighter action figures marketed in the United States.

SOTA玩具的大量《街头霸王》人偶既包括古烈,巴洛克和樱等主角,也有阿顿,元等配角.



E.本田是孩之宝“街头霸王II-特种部队”联名系列中少有的独特造型。其他像桑吉尔夫和春丽等都大幅借鉴了推出过的特种部队人偶。



孩之宝

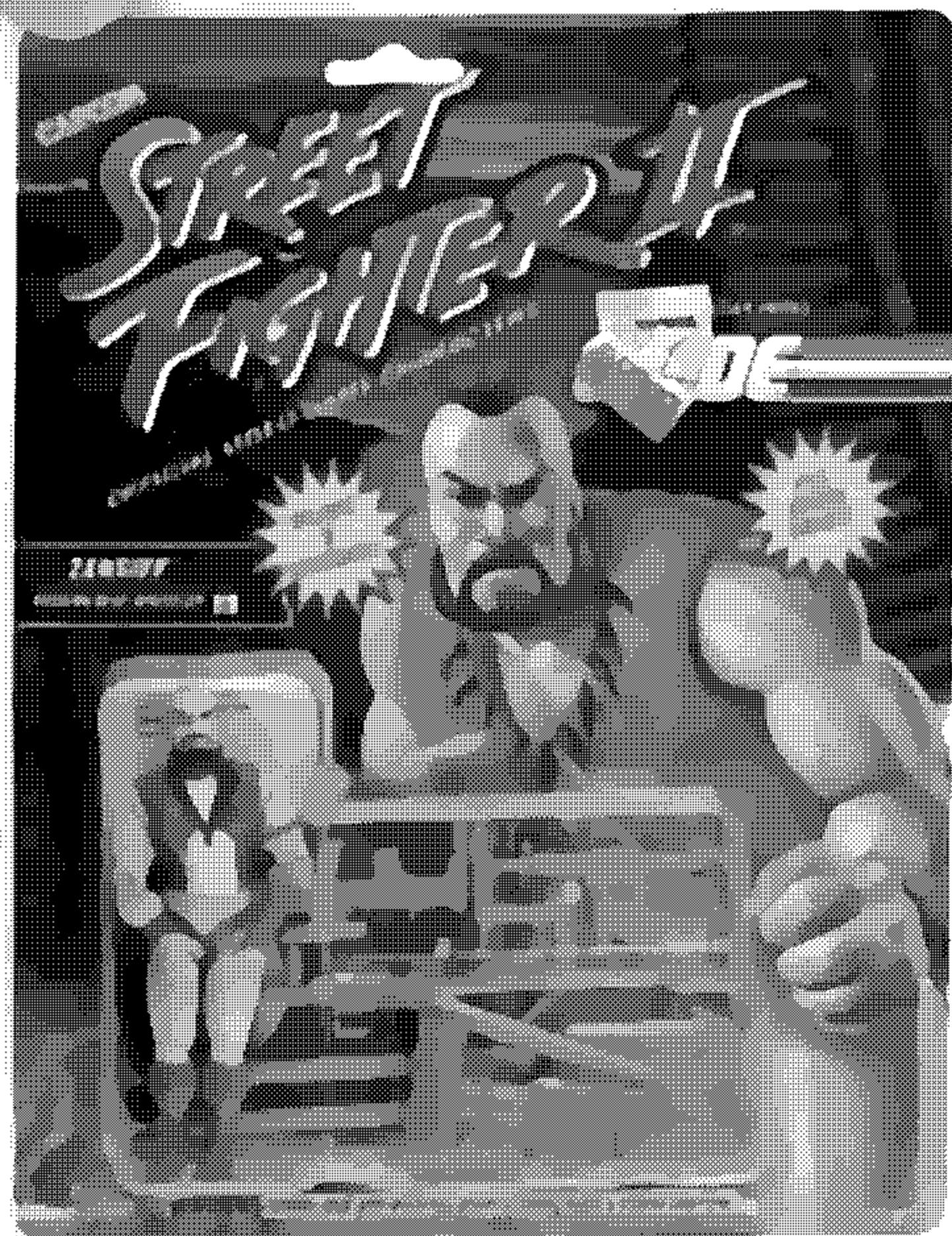
太迟的开始

DURING STREET FIGHTER II'S heyday in the early 1990s, it was easy to love the series, and to love action figures—but difficult to love Street Fighter action figures. The first line from Hasbro in 1993 imagined Capcom's video-game warriors as part of the toymaker's G.I. Joe universe. It almost made sense: Guile, with his U.S. military look, fit right into the Joe-verse. And there were enough martial arts types within Hasbro's franchise, such as Storm Shadow and Snake Eyes, for Ryu and Ken to seem somewhat at home.

But rather than create the Street Fighter figures from scratch, Hasbro repurposed existing G.I. Joe bodies. Although some body-part sharing was common among figures of the era, this was extreme, and many of the Street Fighter characters were scarcely recognizable from the neck down. Zangief's stuff-of-legends chest hair was concealed behind a shirt borrowed from a Joe character named Gnarlyhyde. Blanka was skinny. M. Bison looked like a 1940s bellhop. Chun-Li wore pants instead of her trademark skirt, and her body was identical to the Joe character Scarlett.

"They were fun if you were a kid, partly because it was your only chance to play with these cool Street Fighter characters. But they weren't accurate at all," says Matt Leuck, owner of Quake Collectibles in Evanston, Illinois.

Hasbro created two additional Street Fighter lines over the following couple of years, one based on the Street Fighter live-action movie. (Guile's face was molded in the image of Jean-Claude Van Damme.) Another deluxe, 12-inch line was more faithful to the characters—except for the part where Ryu wields a machine gun.



RESAURUS

《街头霸王》曾是圣杯

IN THE LATE 1990S, Marvel-affiliated ToyBiz released a series of figures related to the *X-Men Vs. Street Fighter* crossover game. The figures greatly improved upon Hasbro's offerings, but belonged more to the aesthetic of Marvel's *X-Men* franchise than to *Street Fighter*. They also eschewed a growing action-figure trend: the statuesque realism that was popular in Asia and gaining steam in the U.S., thanks to makers such as McFarlane Toys, owned by celebrity comic artist Todd McFarlane.

That created an opening for Columbus, Ohio-based ReSaurus, whose action figures were designed by four young friends who had just graduated from the Columbus College of Art and Design.

"It was a chance to work together with your best friends, making toys based on stuff that we all loved," remembers Steve Hamaker, who would take the lead on ReSaurus' *Street Fighter* figures.

Hamaker was a *Street Fighter* fan but figured the license was out of ReSaurus' reach. "*Street Fighter* was the holy grail," he says.

But Capcom did grant ReSaurus the rights to make *Street Fighter* figures, which meant Hamaker and his coworkers had to figure out how they wanted to approach the series. The moment of inspiration came during a 1998 visit to Hong Kong, where Hamaker was overseeing production of the company's line of *Bone* action figures. While there, he saw a resin statue of Akuma that demonstrated the potential of *Street Fighter* figures to capture the snarl and swagger of the characters. He bought the figure and brought it home to Ohio, where he set it on his desk to inspire the ReSaurus team.

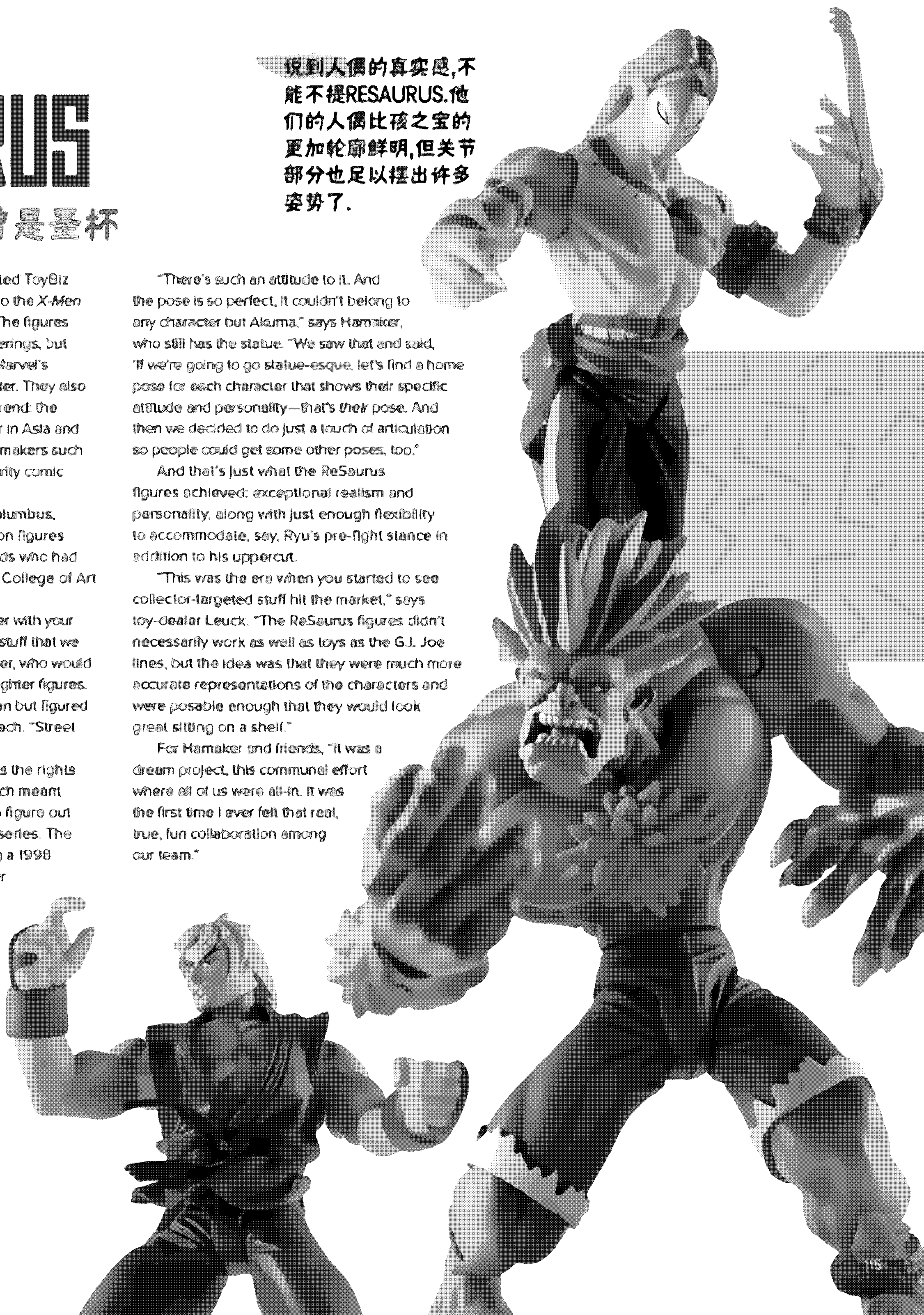
说到人偶的真实感,不能不提RESAURUS.他们的人偶比孩之宝的更加轮廓鲜明,但关节部分也足以摆出许多姿势了。

"There's such an attitude to it. And the pose is so perfect, it couldn't belong to any character but Akuma," says Hamaker, who still has the statue. "We saw that and said, 'If we're going to go statue-esque, let's find a home pose for each character that shows their specific attitude and personality—that's their pose. And then we decided to do just a touch of articulation so people could get some other poses, too.'"

And that's just what the ReSaurus figures achieved: exceptional realism and personality, along with just enough flexibility to accommodate, say, Ryu's pre-fight stance in addition to his uppercut.

"This was the era when you started to see collector-targeted stuff hit the market," says toy-dealer Leuck. "The ReSaurus figures didn't necessarily work as well as toys as the G.I. Joe lines, but the idea was that they were much more accurate representations of the characters and were posable enough that they would look great sitting on a shelf."

For Hamaker and friends, "it was a dream project, this communal effort where all of us were all-in. It was the first time I ever felt that real, true, fun collaboration among our team."



SOTA 玩具

关节连接的时代



THE RESAURUS TEAM OCCASIONALLY worked with freelance sculptors such as Jerry Macaluso of SOTA (short for "State of the Art") Toys. Street Fighter wasn't among the specific titles Macaluso worked on at ReSaurus, but after the company folded in 2001 and executive Ken Lilly departed for Palisades Toys in Ellicott City, Maryland, Macaluso agreed to sculpt Street Fighter figures for Palisades.

One problem: Palisades' deal with Capcom fell through.

Macaluso then made a surprise move. He launched his own line of action figures, based not on super heroes or cartoon characters, but rather on adult-film stars, which he marketed under the brand name Plastic Fantasy. The line was a cult hit that led Macaluso back to the mainstream when actress Angelina Jolie saw the figures and asked that her action figures for the 2001 film *Lara Croft: Tomb Raider* be sculpted in the same style.

SOTA Toys was reborn as a manufacturer, and soon Macaluso had a deal with Capcom to make Street Fighter figures. Macaluso wanted his take on the Street Fighter characters to stand out from the statuesque ReSaurus figures and the similarly rigid figures he had helped develop for Palisades. So he took the opposite approach: "I decided to make them absolutely, fully, crazy articulated."

SOTA, like ReSaurus, would ultimately use a variety of sculptors to craft its figures, but Macaluso created SOTA's first round of Street Fighter figures himself. And he sweated the details.

"We had never done anything super-articulated before, so we took a bunch of figures

SOTA玩具出品的豪鬼既凶狠又灵活,这多亏于人偶精良的关节连接。

apart and just started experimenting. We spent months screwing around with different types of articulation, figuring out how to make the figures balanced," recalls Macaluso. "What we discovered is that most of the articulated figures at that time couldn't stand in extreme poses because they were hollow and didn't have enough weight to hold themselves."

So Macaluso decided to make his Street Fighter figures from solid plastic—a premium step that hadn't been done before with high-articulation figures. That, along with the fact that no new Street Fighter games had been released for five years when SOTA debuted its figures in 2004, prompted some second-guessing among Macaluso's peers.

"People were telling me I was crazy," he recalls. "But we started to tease the figures online, and people really responded."

The figures he released combined the realism and detail of the ReSaurus line with exceptional articulation and even bonuses such as swappable heads and hands. After an era in which figures were marketed more for collectors than for kids, the SOTA line managed to appeal to both demographics at once.

"Companies were learning that a lot of collectors liked to actually open their stuff, and wanted to be able to mimic moves from the game or set up scenes, instead of just having statues of the characters," says Quake Collectibles' Matt Leuck. SOTA's series "was the best of both worlds. A kid could have a ton of fun with them, and so could an adult, but if you're the sort of person who wants to keep the figure in the package, it still looks nice."

The effect of SOTA's line was not only to sell a lot of toys, but also to showcase the power of Street Fighter's brand and the loyalty of its fans—demonstrations of viability that ultimately helped to encourage the development of *Street Fighter IV*.

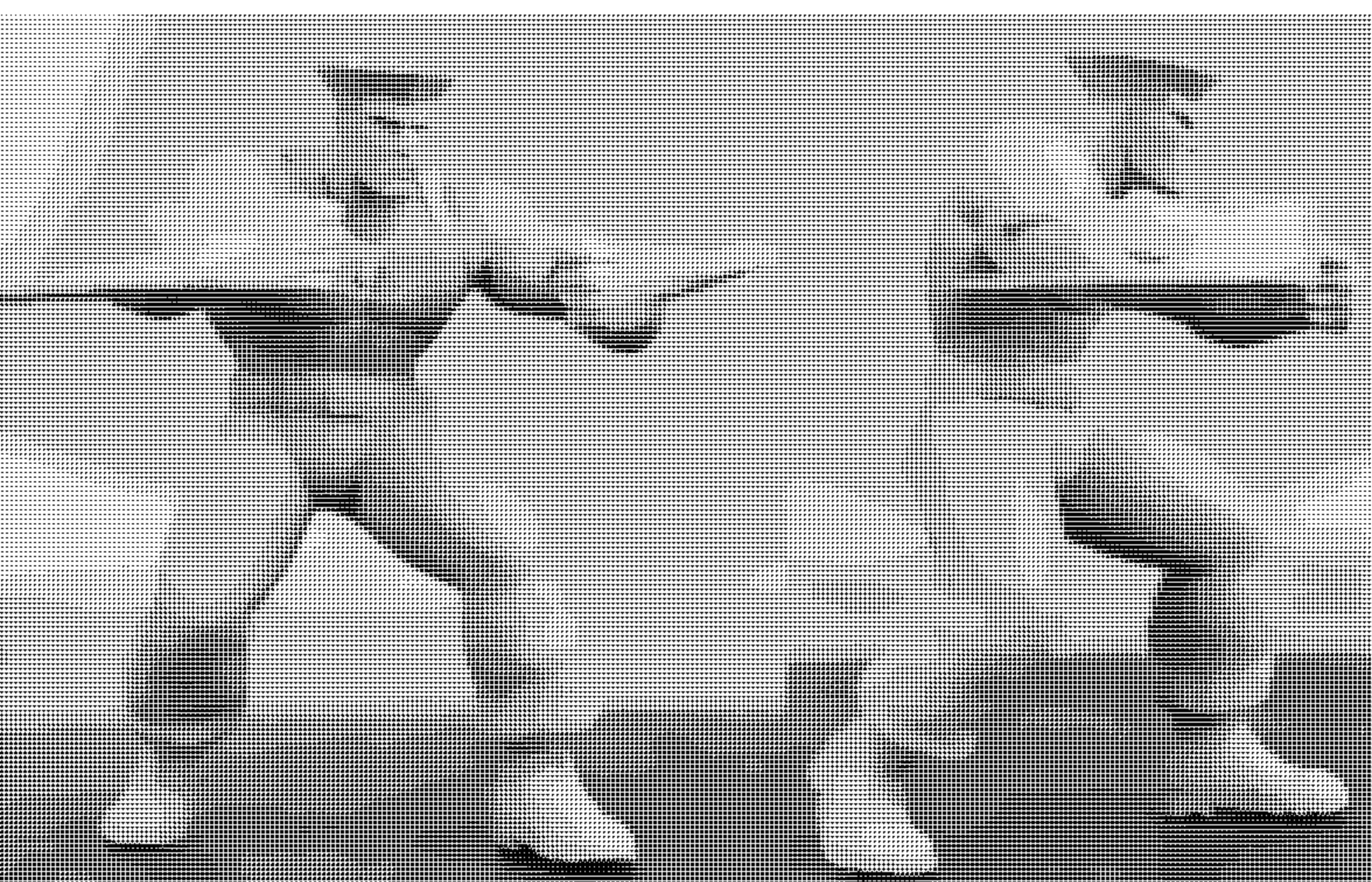
“
我决心要把他们的关节
做得完全,彻底而疯狂。

——杰瑞·马卡卢斯科

在为SOTA玩具开发自己的《街头霸王》人偶生产线之前,杰瑞·马卡卢斯科曾在RESAURUS兼职雕模。他想要让SOTA玩具的人偶比之前那些轮廓鲜明的还要杰出。



右图:这个NECA的古烈人偶穿着查理·纳什的背心,是2009年圣地亚哥国际动漫展独占的。背心用柔韧的PVC材料制作,给关节留出更大的空间;下图:NECA的古烈人偶原型,展现的是角色著名的“音速手刀”攻击。



NECA

圆满的计划

SOON AFTER CAPCOM ANNOUNCED *Street Fighter IV* in 2007, New Jersey-based toymaker NECA (National Entertainment Collectibles Association) struck a deal to create action figures in conjunction with the game's release in 2008. Randy Falk, NECA's senior director of 3D product development, had grown up as a *Street Fighter* fan and collector. He saw potential in the artistic direction of the new game.

"All the characters were a littler thicker, a little meatier, and it was appealing as a fresh spin on the game," remembers Falk.

Another advantage to bigger characters was that they were easier to balance when translated to action-figure form. "Those changes in proportion allowed us to add a ton of articulation, and to have the figures doing things like holding a kicking pose and

recreating a lot of the signature moves without the need for a display stand."

Falk and his team studied in-progress game footage from Capcom Japan, as well as character model sheets that included key poses and 360-degree representations. They also debated which new characters to include. Members of Capcom Japan pushed for Rufus, but Falk chose Crimson Viper as the lone newcomer to accompany series stalwarts like Ryu, Chun-Li and Guile.

The NECA team began sculpting 12-inch-tall figures that were twice as large as the finished product. Once the bodies were set and the faces were identifiable, Falk checked with Yoshinori Ono, *Street Fighter*'s series producer, to make sure they were on the right track.

"It's important to make sure the proportions are right and the foundation is in place before

you do the heavy detail, and before you start cutting everything apart to put in the articulation—the double knees, double elbows, ab crunches, and all the joints people want in figures like these," Falk explains.

Next, Falk's team needed to choose its aesthetic strategy for the characters. Falk decided to strike a balance between the detailed musculature from the gameplay videos and the more illustrated look of Capcom's early marketing materials.

"We used the game art to dictate the articulation and overall look of the body, which meant making the musculature look very lifelike, with striations, cuts and definition on some of the muscle," says Falk. "But then we made some of the facial features a little more sharp and angular, based on the illustrated art."



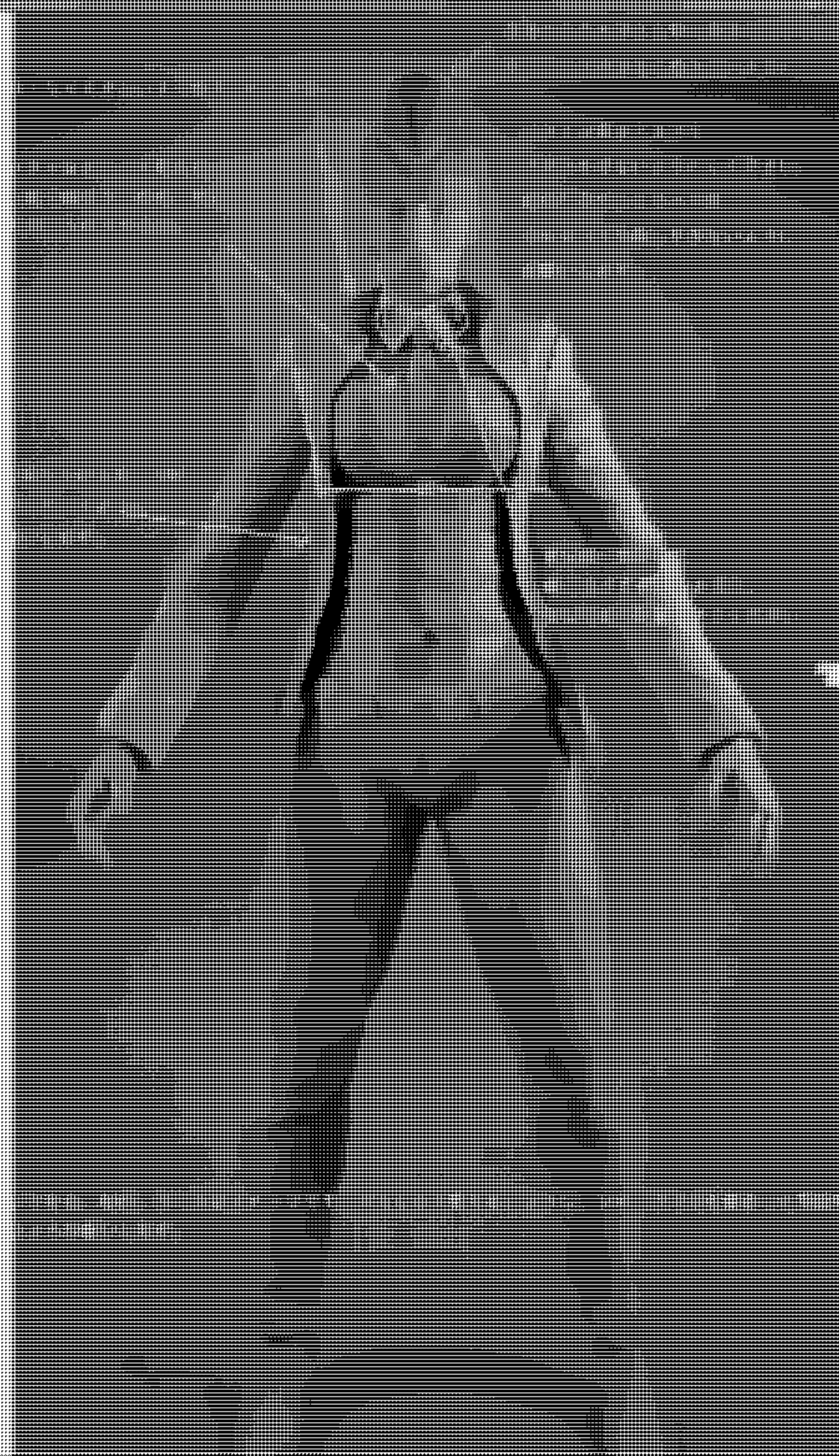
人物都(改得)更厚重一点。
——兰迪·福克



Then came the characters' clothing. Rather than sculpt all the clothing in the same hard plastic as the rest of the figures, Falk opted to use a more flexible, vinyl-like PVC that could bend to accommodate a broad range of character articulations, "so when there's lateral movement in the abs or in the shoulders, the clothing would just sort of move out of the way," Falk explains. Ryu's and Ken's robes and belts got this treatment, as did Chun-Li's skirt and ribbons. (In the photo on the opposite page, Guile's vest is constructed from the flexible material.)

The attention to detail paid off, according to Leuck, the collector.

"You could tell that this is a company that really values accuracy," he says. "You also got the impression that they really like this stuff, that they get as excited as you do."



上图:NECA为其"街头霸王IV"系列做了这个布兰卡不可动人偶原型,但从未发布过;中图:NECA"街头霸王IV"包装里的可动人偶肯正摆出他的胜利姿势;左图:附设设计师反馈的深红毒蛇人偶原型。

凯罗伯和FUNKO

进入小小战士的世界

TWO OF THE MOST popular Street Fighter toy lines today aren't action figures, but Chibi-style vinyl figures made by Everett, Washington-based Funko and Boulder, Colorado-based Kidrobot. Street Fighter is no stranger to the playful, big-head-meets-little-body aesthetic used by both companies—Capcom's game *Super Puzzle Fighter II Turbo* took a similar approach back in 1996.

Both Funko and Kidrobot portray characters through their distinctive lenses, rather than aiming for photorealism. "Our goal in creating a figure is that when somebody looks at it, they say that's obviously Funko and also obviously Street Fighter," says Funko marketing director

Mark Robben. Funko introduced its Street Fighter line in 2016; the collection now includes a dozen figures.

Kidrobot's philosophy and art direction are similar, but the company engages with Street Fighter fans differently, selling its figures in mysterious blind-box packages and releasing a broader number of figures—about three dozen in all. Kidrobot VP Allen Richardson says there's a spiritual connection between his brand and Street Fighter.

"Kidrobot's roots are the streets of New York, and the graffiti art world. I think that really resonates with the deep tournament culture and community of Street Fighter fans," he says.



上图:凯罗伯小不点风格的塑胶人偶;左图:几个FUNKO的“啾啾”街头霸王人偶。

SUPER 7

一切旧式的又成新潮了

FOR FANS OF CLASSIC action figures from the 1980s, Street Fighter's G.I. Joe misfire represented a lost opportunity and also begged the question: what should old-school Street Fighter figures have looked like?

It's a question Brian Flynn set out to answer in 2016. The founder of boutique toy company Super 7 tracked down a few sculptors who had worked in the '70s and '80s for Kenner—a Hasbro rival best known for creating figures for the original *Star Wars* trilogy. He asked those artists to create Street Fighter figures using the same materials and techniques they employed decades ago.

"We wanted to go back and find the answer to what would have been done if Street Fighter had been done correctly," says Flynn.

The result is a collection of six Street Fighter II characters who look far more faithful to their video-game selves than the Hasbro Street Fighter figures did—and the Kenner-style Street Fighters also look remarkably at home in a light-saber battle with a vintage Luke Skywalker. (The Jedi are much less intimidating once they've been on the business end of Zangief's Spinning Piledriver.)

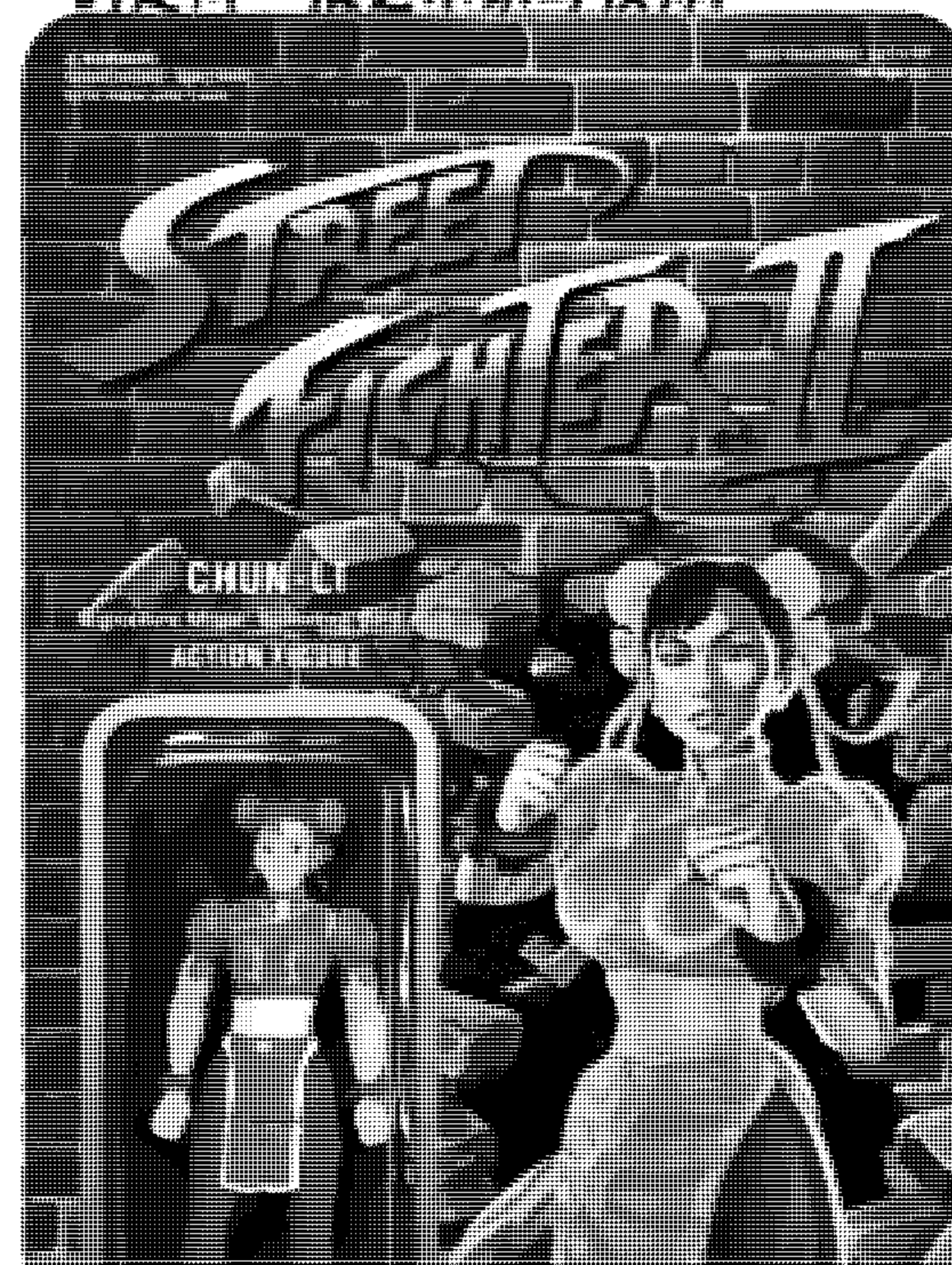
Flynn's design philosophy included an intentional step back from the realism of articulation of modern figures such as those produced by NECA and SOTA Toys.

"I wanted these to evoke the charm and nostalgia of figures from another era, even though they're crude compared to what's made now," he says. "There's an unevenness and an awkwardness to hand-sculpted figures, but when you hold them they still feel organic and real."

Of course, those limitations also serve to illustrate the challenges faced by Hasbro's designers in the early 1990s. The Super 7 versions of Zangief and Chun-Li are the same height, while Blanka sports relatively close-cropped hair in order to allow his neck to turn. And Flynn didn't even touch the iconic Street Fighter character who gave Hasbro fits more than two decades ago: E. Honda is conspicuously absent from the Super 7 line.

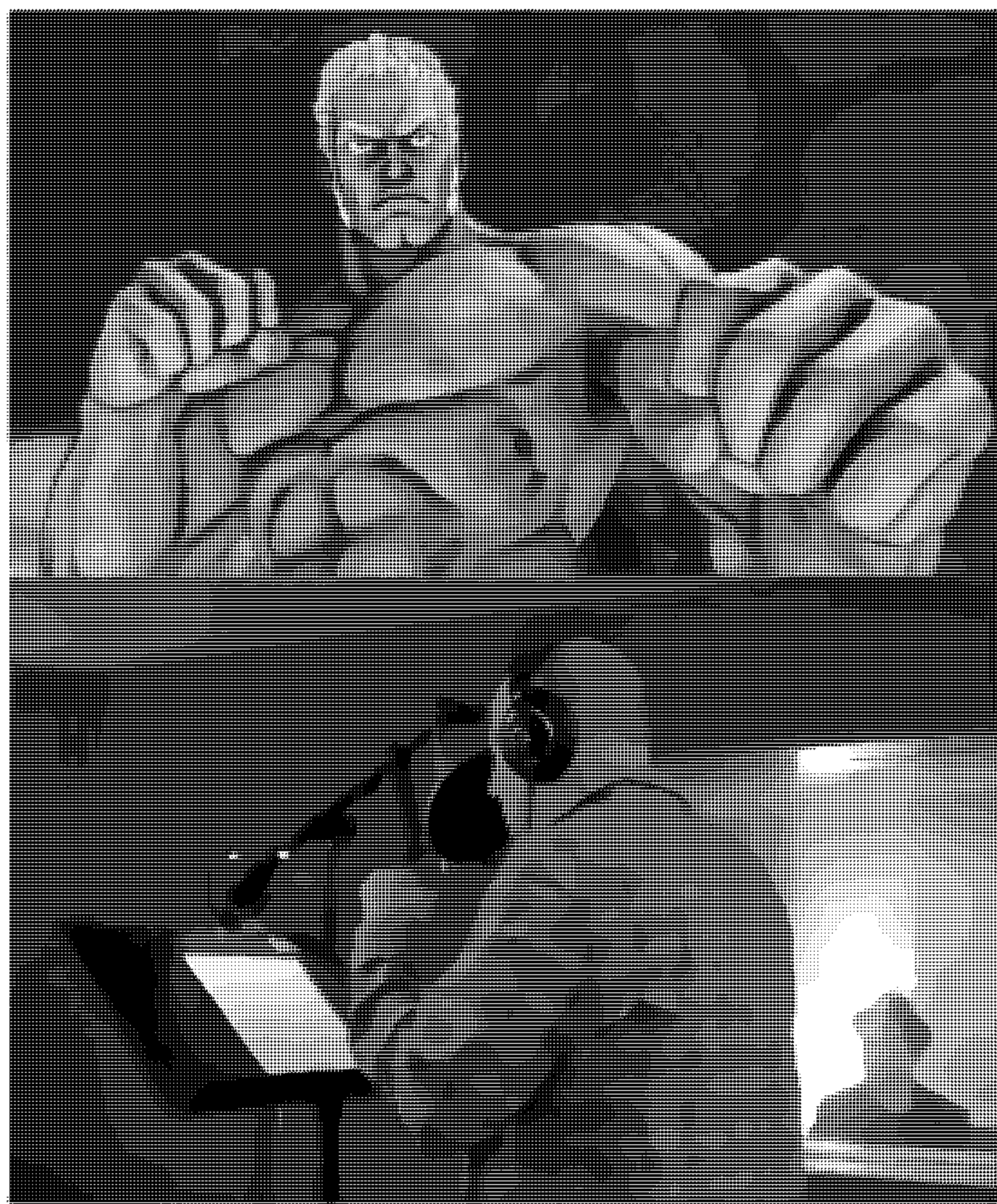


如果说Super7的人偶会令人想起经典的《星球大战》玩具,那就是因为创造它们的是同一批艺术家与技师。

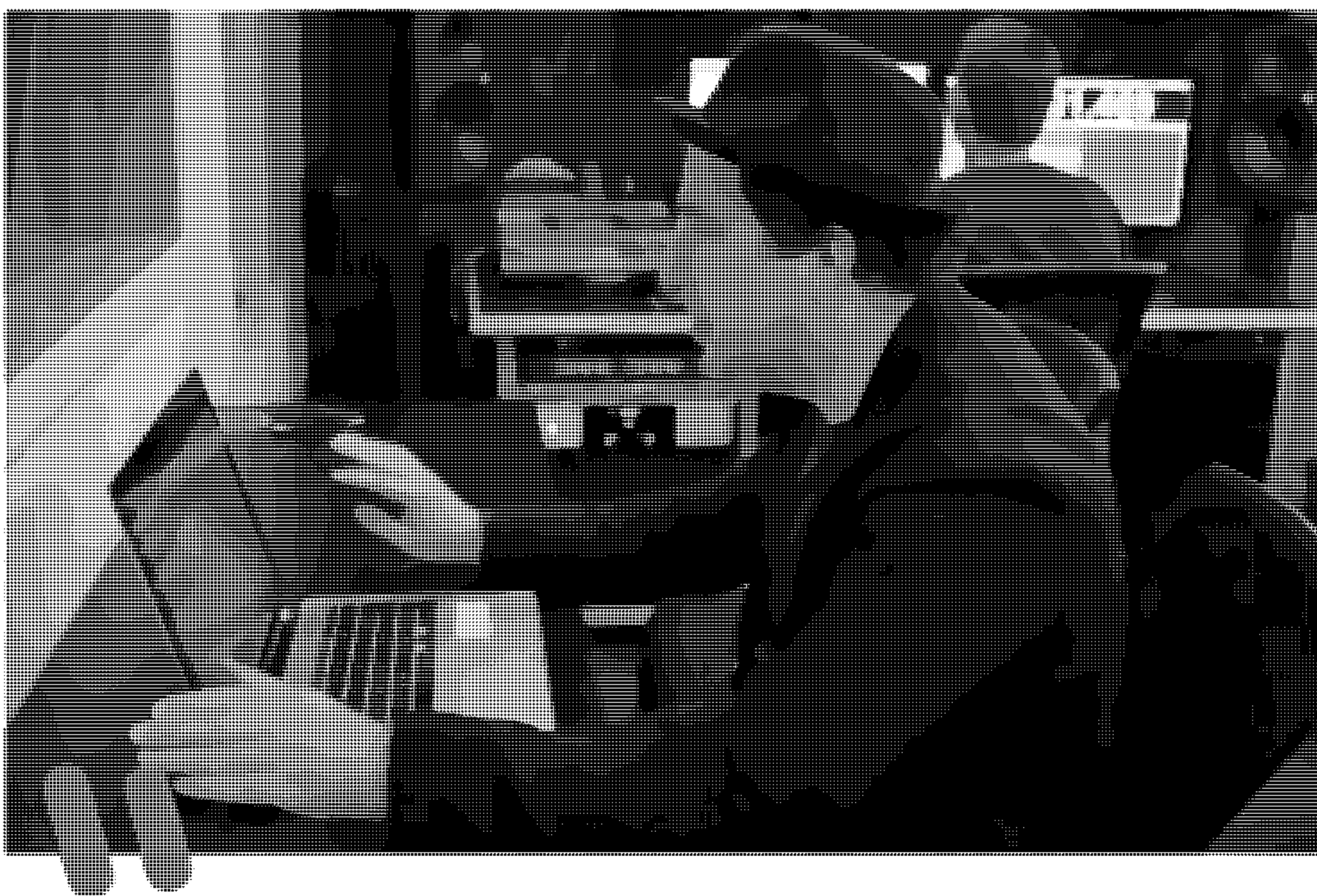


通俗易懂的英语

为西方世界给《街头霸王》配音



右图:《街头霸王V》英文版配音导演乔纳森·克莱因;上图:演员比尔·罗格斯在为尤里配音,而克莱因在隔间里观察。



你不能100%正经地配音…
因为趣味元素也是铸就《街头霸王》的一部分。

—乔纳森·克莱因,《街头霸王V》英文版配音导演

IMAGINE YOU'VE BEEN ENTRUSTED with giving voice to a new Street Fighter character—the monstrous Necalli, for instance, or the boisterous Laura Matsuda. But you haven't seen Necalli's boa-constrictor hair or Laura's electrical outbursts; in fact, you have no idea what these characters look like or how they move. Your only resource in envisioning your character is the script, along with recordings of another actor reading the same lines—in Japanese.

These are the typical circumstances facing actors who portray Street Fighter characters in the English-language versions of the games. Oh, and one more thing: for secrecy purposes, the actors often don't get to see the scripts in advance.

"You have to be ready for anything," says actor Jessica Straus, who has portrayed Juri since the character's introduction in 2010. She didn't find out the name of her character, or that she was working on a Street Fighter game, until she walked into the recording session for *Super Street Fighter IV*. "It's very improvisational and much more fast-paced than acting on stage."

The person tasked with helping each actor deliver a knockout performance is Jonathan Klein of New Generation Pictures, who worked as voice director of the English version of *Street Fighter V* and producer of the English-language version of *Street Fighter IV*. He says fighting games are unique from story-based

games in that much of the characterization is derived from battle scenes rather than narrative.

"Street Fighter is all about the battle itself, because that's where players spend most of their time, and where they encounter all of the other characters," he says. "That means we spend a lot of time focusing on all the fighting and attack sounds, and making sure that the action is dynamic and expressive and cool, and as interesting in English as it is in Japanese."

Crafting a compelling, English-language version of a new Street Fighter game—one originally written and voice-acted in Japanese—is a massive project that requires creativity, precision and endurance. Think

把“波动拳”英译为“火球”在制作《街头霸王IV》时争论过,但还好放弃了。

about all the dialogue in *Street Fighter*: the cutscenes, pre-fight banter, taunts levied between punches, and post-bout gloating—and that's not even counting *Street Fighter V*'s movie-length story mode. Then consider all the other noises unique to *Street Fighter*, each of the grunts, growls, yips and yelps that animate the personalities of world warriors in the midst of battle.

Capturing the performances for a *Street Fighter* game requires a full-day recording session for each character, attended by Klein and a sound engineer. In addition to the voice actor and a Capcom representative. Two hours at least are dedicated to the sounds of punching and being punched before Klein and his actors turn their attention to the most difficult work: capturing dialogue that conveys the emotion and style of the characters while perfectly matching the length and cadence of the Japanese dialogue. The actors' top priority, of course, is to capture the spirit of their characters' personalities. But ranked just below that is the pinpoint timing required to align their performances with those of the

Japanese actors—and, by association, the game animation.

Straus says it's difficult to focus on personality and timing at once.

"It makes it challenging because you're trying to combine the timing with the emotion of the line and also your interpretation of the character," she says. The good news is that she can follow the Japanese performance as a tonal guide, as well as a template for timing.

"Our actors are really, really good at that, but it's a very, very unique skill to be able to speed up, slow down or alter their performance," says Klein.

Sessions also involve frequent script rewrites—trimming or stretching lines either to improve upon the initial translation or to better align with the timing of the Japanese versions.

In most cases, the actors' task is to take a

Japanese phrase and repeat it in English.

Sometimes, though, the English actor repeats a Japanese phrase—Ryu's fireball is called a Hadoken, for example. (The possibility of changing the line to "Fireball" was debated during the making of *Street Fighter IV*, Klein says, but mercifully dropped.) The most difficult lines to replicate are those that the Japanese actors record in English, such as Guile's "Sonic Boom" exclamation. "The Japanese tend to add extra syllables to their English attacks, and it's very challenging for us to find a way to make that fit without making it sound like we're over-emphasizing the wrong syllables," says Klein.

Klein says there's also a lightness to *Street Fighter*, because the characters are playful as well as fearsome.

"Sure, we get dark and serious with some of the Shadaloo characters," Klein says, "but ultimately all of these characters have a fun side as well. You can't play it 100% straight with everything, because that fun element is part of what makes it *Street Fighter*."

演员杰西卡·斯特劳斯
自从韩蛛俐在《超级街
霸IV》中登场时起就一直
为她配音。

你得试着结合台词的情
感与说话的节奏,还要加
入你对角色的演绎。

—杰西卡·斯特劳斯,韩蛛俐的配音



幕后制作

隆标志性的《街头霸王V》艺术画

ARTIST CLARENCE LANSANG GREW up with *Street Fighter* in Southern California. He'd play at the neighborhood 7-Eleven or go to the arcades, where famed players like Tomo Ohira and Mike Watson were hurling fireballs, taking down competitors and building global reputations.

Clarence wasn't an elite *Street Fighter* player, but he was an exceptional artist. When he left the arcade, he would go home and draw the *Street Fighter* characters. Those efforts ultimately led him to a career as an artist. He worked on comic-book series such as *Tomb Raider*, *Witchblade* and *The Darkness*, and also did illustrations for marketing agencies.

His interests converged in 2014, when he heard that Capcom was looking for an iconic image to brand its new game, *Street Fighter V*. Capcom invited Clarence and his team at Ayzenberg Group, the California agency where he is creative director and head of illustration, to make a pitch for the project. Clarence needed to craft an exceptional image.

"I found inspiration in images of characters obscured in the dark, with just an accent of color. I loved that look and wanted to riff off that and apply it to Ryu," Lansang recalls.

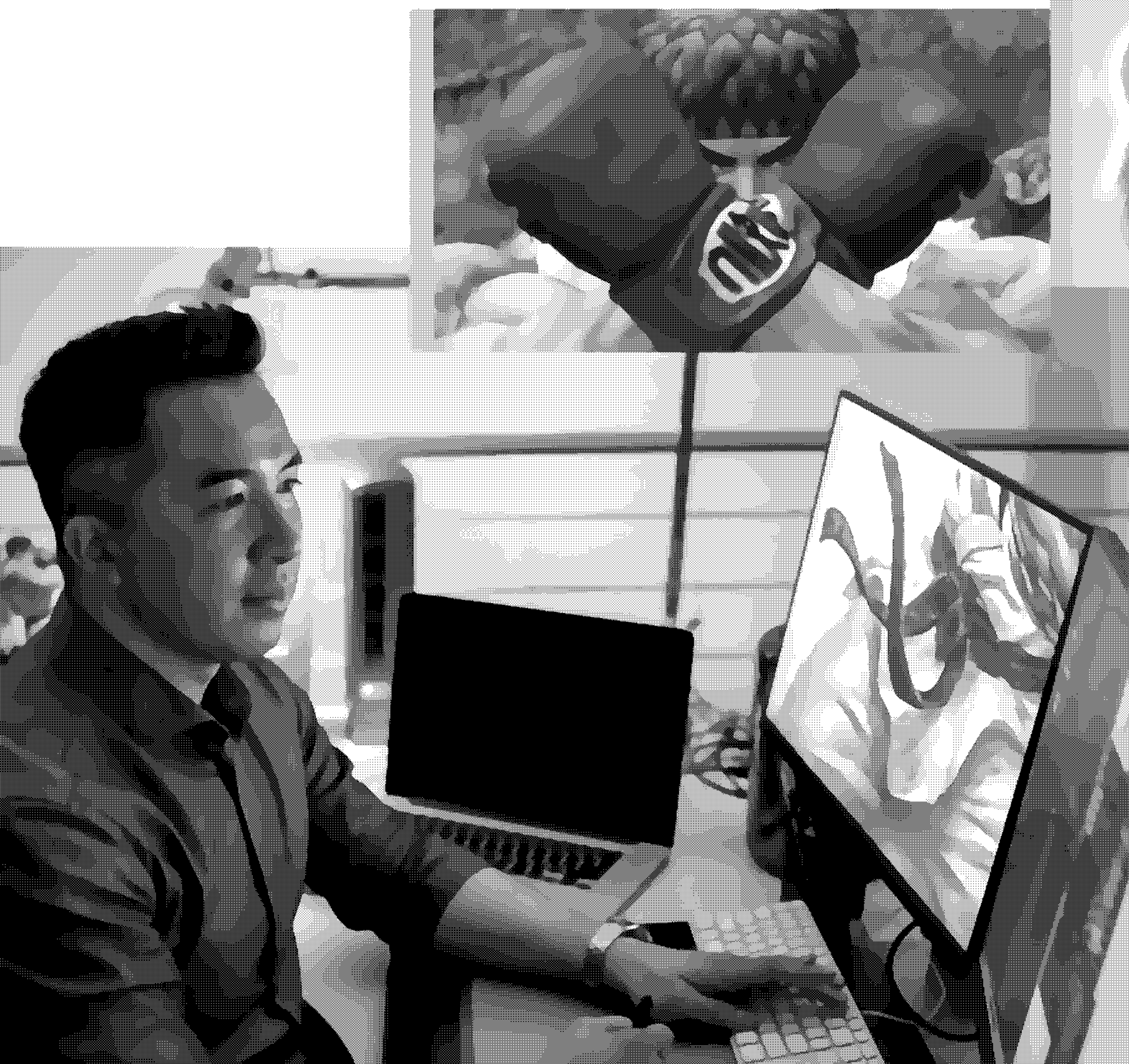
The next step was finding a pose for *Street Fighter V*'s lead character. "I wanted something cool, something dynamic that had a lot of attitude and intensity," says Lansang. He started watching gameplay videos from *Street Fighter IV* and noticed that before Ryu got into his fighting stance, he crossed his arms. That look did the job—and as a bonus, the resulting "V" shape of Ryu's arms evoked the roman numeral that matched *Street Fighter V*.

For the pitch to Capcom, Lansang took a small initial sketch of Ryu with arms folded, enlarged it, then painted over it—adding the crossed gloves and details to Ryu's gi along the way. "I wanted it to be very illustrative, very painterly, and to have that feel but also to be very high-fidelity. So I tried

我想让你感受到潜在的力量感。

—克拉伦斯·兰桑,画师





兰桑为了说服卡普空,先把这张隆的画作画在了黑色背景上,强调隆的手套与头带鲜红的色调。他把一张《街头霸王IV》中隆双臂交错的照片用作参考。随后,兰桑还模仿着隆的站姿给自己拍了几张照片。他基于这些照片创作了概念图。等卡普空通过概念图后,他转向黑色画布,将草稿画成了最终的成品。

to emphasize prominent brushstrokes but also to keep it tight, clean and well designed, so that there's an elegance to it."

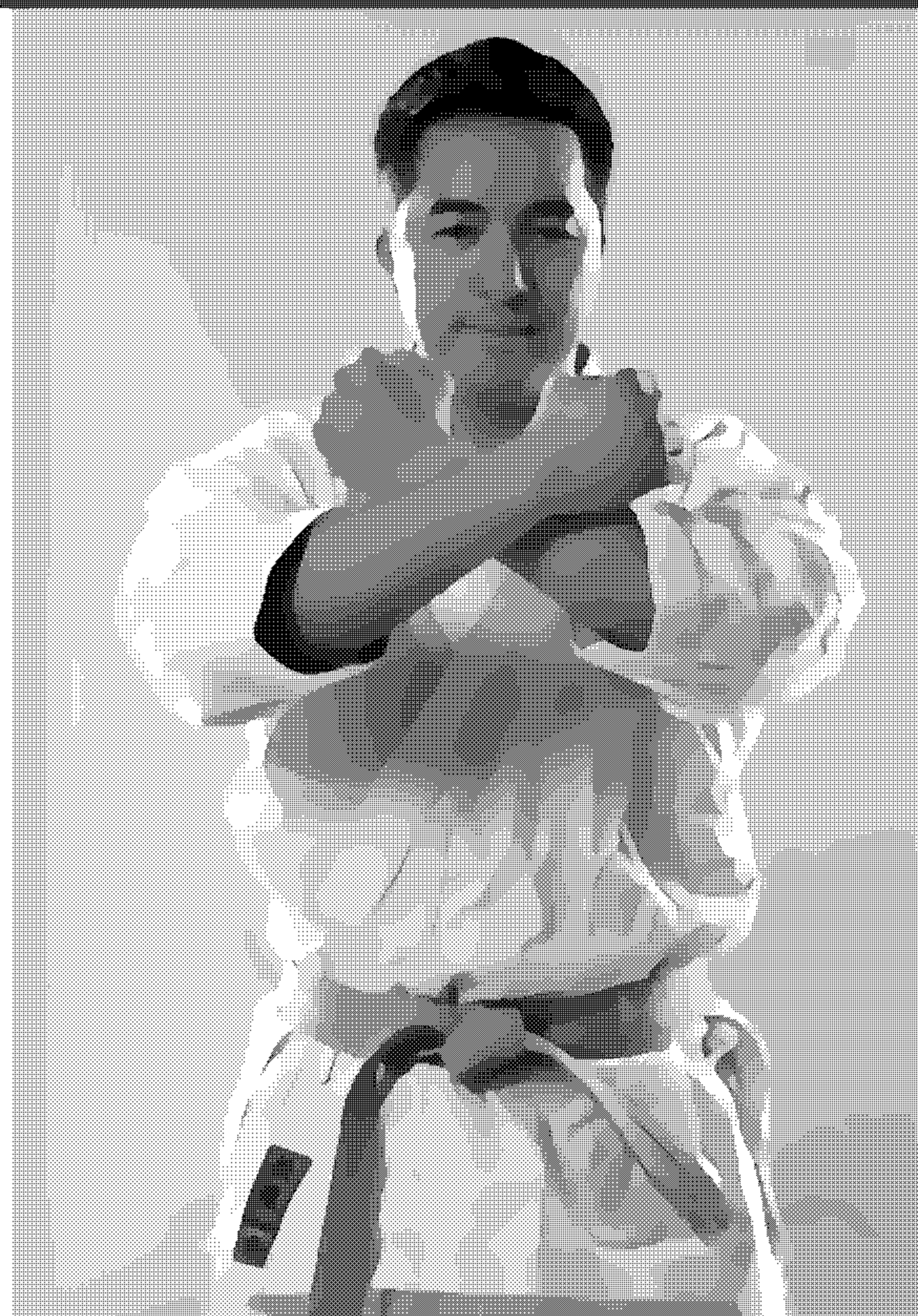
The team from Capcom was blown away. They didn't just say "Yes," they said "Yes, and don't change a thing"—an extreme rarity in Lansang's industry. The only real tweak as he headed into final production was to change the background from black to white, in order to differentiate *Street Fighter V* from its competitors.

To create the final version, Lansang put on a karate gi and took a photo of himself, flexing in Ryu's crossed-arms pose. Then, using the photo as a guide, he began to paint, focusing

on Ryu's expression. "He's in a static pose, but I wanted to make sure it was powerful, and that his eyes have this intensity and confidence," Lansang says. "I wanted you to feel this sense of potential energy."

The result was a hit: that image graces *SFV* art around the world and won a Clio Award for creative excellence. For Lansang, the positive reception was a sign his career had come full circle.

"The *Street Fighter* characters have always been such an inspiration to me. To finally have a piece that's part of that collection of awesome art, it's like 'Wow.' For me, it's a career-defining piece." ■





LANSANG'S art was used as the centerpiece of Street Fighter V promotions around the world, including conventions such as the Electronic Entertainment Expo in Los Angeles, as well as on magazine covers and at game rental kiosks and amusement parks.

我想要确保它风格有力，
并且在隆的眼中显现出
专注与自信。

—克拉伦斯·兰桑,画师

